MUST-SCORE FACTS

Art and Culture

Consolidated Must-Score Facts and must-score drill cards for every chapter.

UPPCS + UKPCS Study Library · chapter order follows Subject Notes.

Chapters

1. Daily Read — High-Yield Revision Facts
2. Topic 1 — Institutions Related to Indian Culture
3. Topic 2 — Religious and Philosophical Traditions
4. Topic 3 — Indian Architecture
5. Topic 4 — Indian Painting
6. Topic 5 — Indian Music
7. Topic 6 — Indian Dance
8. Topic 7 — Indian Theatre & Performing Arts
9. Topic 8 — Indian Languages & Literature
10. Topic 9 — Indian Festivals & Fairs
11. Topic 10 — Ancient Indian History Related to Culture
12. Topic 11 — Medieval Indian Cultural History
13. Topic 12 — Sculpture
14. Topic 13 — Folk Culture
15. Topic 14 — Cultural Heritage
16. Topic 15 — Archaeology
17. Topic 16 — Awards, Personalities & GI Tags
18. Topic 17 — UP Art, Culture & Demographics
19. Uttarakhand — Topic 1 — Folk Culture of UK
20. Uttarakhand — Topic 2 — Dances, Music & Fairs
21. Uttarakhand — Topic 3 — Heritage & Cultural Institutes
22. Uttarakhand — Topic 4 — Personalities, Literature & Press

Daily Read — High-Yield Revision Facts

1. The 8 Classical Dances of India (Recognized by Sangeet Natak Akademi)

Dance Form	State of Origin	Key Pioneers & Revivalists	Notable Exponents	Distinctive Features, Repertoire & Exam Keywords
Bharatanatyam	**Tamil Nadu**	**E. Krishna Iyer**, **Rukmini Devi Arundale** (founder of Kalakshetra Foundation)	Yamini Krishnamurthy, Padma Subrahmanyam, Alarmel Valli, Mrinalini Sarabhai	Regarded as the **oldest classical dance** of India, originating from ancient temple dancer (*Devadasi*) traditions where it was historically known as *Sadir* or *Dasi Attam*. It symbolizes the element of fire (*Agni*) and features the characteristic half-sitting stance termed **Araimandi**. A complete traditional recital follows the structured sequence: *Alarippu* → *Jatiswaram* → *Shabdam* → *Varnam* → *Padam* → *Tillana*. It is performed in the *Ekaharya* format, wherein a single performer assumes and portrays multiple roles.
Kathak	**Uttar Pradesh**	**Lady Leela Sokhey** (Madame Menaka), **Nawab Wajid Ali Shah** (patron of Lucknow Gharana)	**Pt. Birju Maharaj**, Sitara Devi, Shambhu Maharaj, Lachhu Maharaj, Damayanti Joshi	The name derives from the ancient aphorism *"Katha Kahe So Kathak Kahave"* (one who recites stories is a Kathak). The dance is characterized by intricate and swift rhythmic footwork (**Tatkar**), dazzling pirouettes (**Chakkars**), expressive gait narratives (*Gat Nikas*), and dynamic rhythmic contests (*Jugalbandi*) with the tabla. Its major gharanas include **Lucknow** (famed for grace, *Bhava*, and subtle mime), **Jaipur** (distinguished by fiery footwork, speed, and *Veer rasa*), **Banaras**, and **Raigarh**.
Kathakali	**Kerala**	**Vallathol Narayana Menon** (founder of Kerala Kalamandalam)	Kalamandalam Gopi, Guru Kunchu Kurup, Raman Kutty Nair	A grand visual dance-drama enacting epic narratives from the Ramayana and Mahabharata. It is celebrated for its elaborate facial makeup (*Chutti*) and ornate towering headgear. Character types are defined by strict symbolic facial colors: **Pacha** (green makeup, depicting divine heroes and noble kings), **Kathi** (knife-shaped red streaks on green with a white nose-knob, representing arrogant royalty and villains), **Thadi** (bearded characters: red/black for evil demons, white for pious figures like Hanuman), and **Minukku** (warm yellow/flesh tone, representing virtuous women and sages).
Kuchipudi	**Andhra Pradesh**	**Siddhendra Yogi** (creator of *Bhamakalapam*)	Yamini Krishnamurthy, Raja & Radha Reddy, Swapnasundari	Named after its village of origin, Kuchelapuram in Krishna district, this form developed as a dance-drama tradition combining spoken dialogue, classical singing, and dance. Its most celebrated virtuoso feature is the **Tarangam**, in which the dancer deftly balances upon the raised rim of a brass plate while carrying a brass water pitcher (*Kundi*) balanced steadily atop the head.
Odissi	**Odisha**	**Kelucharan Mohapatra**, Pankaj Charan Das, Deba Prasad Das	Sonal Mansingh, Sanjukta Panigrahi, Madhavi Mudgal	Deeply rooted in temple rituals, its lineage traces back to female temple dancers (*Maharis*) and juvenile male performers (*Gotipuas*). The performance repertoire is heavily inspired by Jayadeva's devotional masterpiece, the *Gita Govinda*. It is distinguished by two fundamental body postures: the feminine, soft, three-bend deflective stance (**Tribhanga**) and the firm, square, masculine stance (**Chowk**).

Dance Form	State of Origin	Key Pioneers & Revivalists	Notable Exponents	Distinctive Features, Repertoire & Exam Keywords
Sattriya	**Assam**	**Mahapurusha Srimanta Sankardeva** (15th century)	Bhabananda Barbayan, Jatin Goswami, Ghanakanta Bora	Created as an instrument of the Neo-Vaishnavite Bhakti movement, this sacred dance form was nurtured for over five centuries inside monastic sanctuaries known as **Sattras**. Its musical and theatrical foundation rests upon *Borgeet* (devotional songs) and *Ankiya Nat* (one-act devotional plays). The Sangeet Natak Akademi officially recognized Sattriya as India's 8th classical dance in **November 2000**.
Manipuri	**Manipur**	**King Bhagyachandra** (Ningthou Ching-Thang Khomba), **Rabindranath Tagore** (introduced at Santiniketan)	Guru Bipin Singh, Jhaveri Sisters (Nayna, Suvarna, Darshana, Ranjana), Charu Mathur	Centered upon the immortal, tender love of Radha and Krishna through devotional **Raslila** performances. It is distinguished by soft, undulating, lyrical movements in which the dancer's feet never strike the floor sharply. Female dancers wear an ornate, stiff cylindrical skirt known as the **Potloi** or *Kumin*. Performances are traditionally complemented by the energetic, acrobatic drum dance called **Pung Cholom**.
Mohiniyattam	**Kerala**	**Maharaja Swathi Thirunal** of Travancore, **Vallathol Narayana Menon**	Sunanda Nair, Bharati Shivaji, Kanak Rele, Gopika Varma	Literally meaning the "Dance of the Enchantress", this dance draws mythological inspiration from Lord Vishnu's Mohini incarnation. It is performed strictly as a solo feminine recital embodying pure **Lasya** (delicate, wave-like, swaying body movements resembling palm fronds). Performers are clad in a signature pristine off-white handloom saree embellished with a shimmering golden brocade border, known as the **Kasavu saree**.

2. Classical Languages of India (Chronology & Criteria)

A. Chronological Order of Recognition

1. **Tamil** (Declared in **2004**) — Conferred status as India's first Classical Language.
2. **Sanskrit** (Declared in **2005**).
3. **Telugu** (Declared in **2008**).
4. **Kannada** (Declared in **2008**).
5. **Malayalam** (Declared in **2013**).
6. **Odia** (Declared in **2014**).
7. **Marathi** (Approved by the Union Cabinet on **3 October 2024**).
8. **Pali** (Approved on **3 October 2024**).
9. **Prakrit** (Approved on **3 October 2024**).
10. **Assamese** (Approved on **3 October 2024**).
11. **Bengali** (Approved on **3 October 2024**).

(India officially recognizes 11 Classical Languages following the landmark Union Cabinet decision of October 2024.)

B. Eligibility Criteria (Ministry of Culture)

To qualify for status as a Classical Language, a language must satisfy the following four criteria formulated by the Ministry of Culture: - **High Antiquity:** Recorded history and early literary texts spanning a historical antiquity of **1500 to 2000 years**. - **Valuable Heritage:** A treasured corpus of ancient literature and texts cherished as invaluable heritage by generations of speakers. - **Original Literary Tradition:** A literary heritage that is demonstrably authentic and original, not borrowed from another speech community. - **Linguistic Distinctiveness:** A distinct divergence

between the classical language and its modern forms or vernacular offshoots, acknowledging potential historical discontinuity across later evolutionary stages.

3. Temple Architecture Styles & Architectural Anatomy

NAGARA vs DRAVIDA ARCHITECTURE	
NAGARA (North Indian Style)	**DRAVIDA (South Indian Style)**
• Curvilinear tower: Shikhara	• Stepped-pyramidal tower: Vimana
• Crowning Amalaka & Kalasha	• Crowning octagonal/dome Stupika
• Built on a raised plinth: Jagati	• Enclosed by elaborate boundary wall
• Monumental gateways absent	• Towering ornamental gates: Gopuram
• Temple water tanks not mandatory	• Temple water tank (Kalyani) inside
• Sub-types: Rekha-Deula, Phamsana	• Multi-pillared assembly Mandapas

A. Core Architectural Vocabulary

- **Garbhagriha (Sanctum Sanctorum):** The innermost, unadorned sacred chamber housing the principal deity, designed to focus divine energy.
- **Mandapa:** A pillared hall situated in front of the sanctum, serving as a gathering space for devotees during rituals.
- **Antarala (Vestibule):** An intermediate foyer or transit vestibule connecting the Garbhagriha with the main Mandapa.
- **Shikhara (North) / Vimana (South):** The monumental mountain-like spire rising skyward directly over the Garbhagriha.
- **Amalaka:** A large, fluted circular stone disc resembling a myrobalan fruit, installed at the apex of a Nagara Shikhara.
- **Kalasha:** A pot- or pitcher-shaped decorative finial placed directly atop the Amalaka as the highest point of the temple.
- **Gopuram:** A towering, monumental gateway providing entrance through the perimeter walls of South Indian Dravidian temple complexes.
- **Panchayatana Style:** An architectural layout where the main central shrine is symmetrically flanked by **four smaller subsidiary shrines** at the corners (prominent examples include the Dashavatara Temple at Deogarh, and the Kandariya Mahadeva and Lakshmana temples at Khajuraho).

B. Masterpiece Temples, Dynasties & Architectural Highlights

Temple Name	Location	Builder Dynasty & Ruler	Architectural Style & Primary Exam Significance
Kailasa Temple (Cave 16)	Ellora (Maharashtra)	**Krishna I** (Rashtrakuta Dynasty, 8th century CE)	Celebrated as the **world's largest monolithic rock-cut monument**, excavated vertically from top to bottom out of a single volcanic basalt cliff face.
Shore Temple	Mamallapuram (Tamil Nadu)	**Narasimhavarman II Rajasimha** (Pallava Dynasty)	One of the earliest free-standing structural stone temples in Southern India, built on the edge of the Bay of Bengal; designated a UNESCO World Heritage Site.
Brihadeshwara (Rajarajeshwara)	Thanjavur (Tamil Nadu)	**Rajaraja I Chola** (consecrated in 1010 CE)	Represents the zenith of Dravida architecture, crowned by a massive 66-metre pyramidal Vimana and an 80-tonne monolithic granite Stupika; renowned for its shadow engineering.

Temple Name	Location	Builder Dynasty & Ruler	Architectural Style & Primary Exam Significance
Gangaikonda Cholapuram	Ariyalur (Tamil Nadu)	**Rajendra I Chola** (1035 CE)	Commissioned to commemorate Rajendra I's victorious military campaign to the holy River Ganga; features a graceful, concave-curving Vimana profile.
Sun Temple	Konark (Odisha)	**Narasimhadeva I** (Eastern Ganga Dynasty, 13th century CE)	Designed in the form of an immense stone chariot dedicated to the Sun God Surya, complete with 24 carved stone wheels and 7 galloping horses; historically termed the **"Black Pagoda"**.
Jagannath Temple	Puri (Odisha)	**Anantavarman Chodaganga** (Eastern Ganga Dynasty)	A quintessential monument of the Kalinga Nagara style (Rekha-Deula); celebrated for the world-famous Ratha Yatra and historically known as the **"White Pagoda"**.
Lingaraja Temple	Bhubaneswar (Odisha)	Somavamshi Dynasty (King Yayati I)	Regarded as the most complete and magnificent specimen of Kalinga architecture, showcasing all four classic halls: Deula, Jagamohana, Natamandapa, and Bhogamandapa.
Sun Temple	Modhera (Gujarat)	**Bhima I** (Solanki / Chaulukya Dynasty, 1026 CE)	Built in the ornate Maru-Gurjara style; renowned for its grand stepped water tank (**Surya Kund**) adorned with 108 miniature shrines along its terraces.
Kandariya Mahadeva Temple	Khajuraho (Madhya Pradesh)	**Dhangadeva / Vidyadhara** (Chandela Dynasty, 10th–11th century CE)	The largest and most elaborate Hindu temple at Khajuraho; erected on a Panchayatana plan with a soaring Shikhara accompanied by 84 subsidiary spires (*Urushringas*).
Dilwara Jain Temples	Mount Abu (Rajasthan)	**Vimal Shah** (Vimal Vasahi, 1031 CE) & **Tejpala / Vastupala** (Luna Vasahi, 1230 CE)	Outstanding examples of Solanki temple craft, internationally famous for their luminous, translucent white marble ceiling carvings and filigree stonework.
Hoysaleswara Temple	Halebidu (Karnataka)	King Vishnuvardhana (Hoysala Dynasty)	Carved from soft chloritic schist (soapstone) on a stellate (star-shaped) plinth, covered in intricate, continuous narrative friezes; inscribed as a UNESCO World Heritage Site in 2023.
Chennakeshava Temple	Belur (Karnataka)	King Vishnuvardhana (Hoysala Dynasty, 1117 CE)	Built to commemorate Hoysala military triumphs; celebrated for its star-shaped sanctum and masterfully sculpted *Madanika* bracket figures; inscribed as a UNESCO World Heritage Site in 2023.
Dashavatara Temple	Deogarh (Lalitpur district, UP)	Gupta Period (6th century CE)	Stands as the **earliest surviving Panchayatana stone temple in Northern India**, famous for its classical relief depiction of Sheshashayi Vishnu reclining on the serpent Shesha.
Bhitargaon Temple	Kanpur district (UP)	Gupta Period (5th century CE; Gupta imperial span c. 320–550 CE)	Recognized as the **oldest surviving terracotta and brick temple** in India featuring a genuine radiating structural arch.

Dynastic Spans for Key Temple Builders: Gupta Empire (c. 320–550 CE: Deogarh, Bhitargaon); Imperial Pallavas (c. 575–897 CE: Shore Temple under Rajasimha); Rashtrakutas (c. 753–973 CE: Kailasa Temple under Krishna I); Imperial Cholas (c. 850–1279 CE: Rajaraja I in 1010 CE, Rajendra I in 1035 CE); Chandelas of Jejakabhukti (c. 9th–13th century CE: Khajuraho); Eastern Gangas (c. 11th–15th century CE: Konark, Puri); Hoysalas (c. 11th–14th century CE: Belur in 1117 CE, Halebidu); Solankis / Chaulukyas of Gujarat (c. 10th–13th century CE: Modhera in 1026 CE).

4. Fairs and Festivals of India, Uttar Pradesh & Uttarakhand

A. Major National Cultural Festivals

- **Hornbill Festival (Nagaland):** Held annually from 1 to 10 December at the Naga Heritage Village in Kisama; acclaimed as the "Festival of Festivals", it showcases the collective traditions of all 16 recognized Naga tribes.
- **Bihu (Assam):** Celebrated across three distinct agricultural cycles: *Rongali (Bohag) Bihu* in spring (April) marking the Assamese New Year, *Kongali (Kati) Bihu* in autumn marking crop protection, and *Bhogali (Magh) Bihu* in winter marking the post-harvest feast.
- **Chapchar Kut (Mizoram):** Celebrated with great joy in spring after the completion of jhum (slash-and-burn) clearing operations; famously features the traditional *Cheraw* bamboo dance.
- **Losar (Ladakh, Sikkim, Arunachal Pradesh):** The traditional Buddhist and Tibetan New Year festival, observed with monastic mask dances (*Cham*) and elaborate symbolic offerings.
- **Pushkar Fair (Ajmer, Rajasthan):** One of the world's largest livestock and camel trading fairs, organized during Kartik Purnima along the holy banks of Lake Pushkar.
- **Thrissur Pooram (Kerala):** Staged at the Vadakkunnathan Temple in Thrissur; renowned for competitive temple displays featuring caparisoned elephants, dynamic parasol exchanges (*Kudamattam*), and majestic traditional percussion ensembles (*Panchavadyam*).
- **Wangala Festival (Garo Hills, Meghalaya):** Known as the "100 Drum Festival", this post-harvest celebration is observed by the Garo tribe in honor of Saljong, the Sun God of fertility.

B. Uttar Pradesh Fairs & Festivals (High-Yield State Core)

- **Kumbh Mela & Magh Mela (Prayagraj):** Organized at the sacred Triveni Sangam (confluence of the Ganga, Yamuna, and mythical Saraswati); the Maha Kumbh takes place every 12 years, with the annual Magh Mela held during the Hindu month of Magha.
- **Bateshwar Fair (Bateshwar, Agra):** A renowned historic cattle and livestock fair hosted along the Yamuna riverbank, famous for its picturesque riverside cluster of 101 Shiva temples.
- **Nauchandi Mela (Meerut):** A celebrated symbol of communal fraternity held after Holi, where pilgrims pay homage concurrently to the shrine of Nav Chandi Devi and the dargah of Sufi saint Hazrat Bale Miyan.
- **Shakumbhari Devi Mela (Saharanpur):** Organized twice every year during the auspicious Chaitra and Ashwin Navratris at the historic Shakumbhari Devi Peeth in the Shivalik foothills.
- **Devi Patan Mela (Tulsipur, Balrampur):** A major annual fair held at the sacred Devi Patan Shaktipeeth, deeply revered across the Indo-Nepal Terai region.
- **Dadri Mela (Ballia):** Regarded as India's second-largest cattle fair, historically established and named in commemoration of the revered sage Dardar Muni.
- **Govardhan Parikrama & Lathmar Holi (Mathura, Barsana & Nandgaon):** Centuries-old Braj traditions featuring circumambulation of the sacred Govardhan Hill and the joyous playful stick-and-shield Holi celebrations between the women of Barsana and the men of Nandgaon.
- **Taj Mahotsav (Agra):** A vibrant 10-day cultural extravaganza organized each February at Shilpgram near the Taj Mahal, highlighting Mughal crafts, culinary arts, and folk performances.
- **Sulh-i-Kul Festival (Agra):** Inspired by Emperor Akbar's imperial principle of universal peace and religious tolerance (*Sulh-i-Kul*), this festival serves as a cornerstone of interfaith unity.

C. Uttarakhand Fairs & Festivals (UKPCS Priority)

- **Nanda Devi Raj Jat (Chamoli, Uttarakhand):** Organized **once every 12 years**, this epic 280-kilometre barefoot pilgrimage spans from Nauti village to the sacred lake of Homkund at the base of Mount Trishul, led by a sacred four-horned ram (**Chasingha Khadu**).
- **Ramman (Saloor-Dungra village, Joshimath, Chamoli):** A ritualistic religious festival and folk theatre dedicated to the tutelary deity **Bhumiyal Devta**; features masked dances utilizing traditional painted wooden masks and

has been inscribed on UNESCO's Intangible Cultural Heritage list.

- **Bagwal Mela / Stone-Throwing Fair (Devidhura, Champawat):** Celebrated annually on Raksha Bandhan at the Maa Varahi Devi Temple, where warriors of four local clans (*Khams*) traditionally engage in stone-hurling ritual combat.
- **Purnagiri Mela (Tanakpur, Champawat):** Attracts hundreds of thousands of devotees during Chaitra Navratri to the Purnagiri Shaktipeeth perched above the Sharda (Kali) River.
- **Uttarayani Mela (Bageshwar):** Celebrated on Makar Sankranti at the holy confluence of the Saryu and Gomati rivers; carries immense modern historical importance as the site where registers of the oppressive Coolie-Begar forced labor system were dumped into the river in 1921.
- **Jaiti Mela (Almora):** A traditional cultural fair of the Kumaon region, featuring spirited performances of the circular *Jhora* dance and traditional folk ballads.

5. UNESCO Tangible World Heritage Sites in India (45 Total Sites)

India currently possesses 45 inscribed UNESCO World Heritage Sites following the historic inscription of Sarnath in July 2026.

- **The Sole Mixed Heritage Site: Khangchendzonga National Park** (Sikkim, inscribed in 2016 for combined natural and cultural criteria).
- **Latest Landmark Inscriptions:**
- **#45: Ancient Buddhist Site of Sarnath (Uttar Pradesh)** — Inscribed in **July 2026** at the 48th World Heritage Committee session in Busan. This serial cultural site encompasses the monumental **Chaukhandi Stupa** together with the excavated core remains including the Dhamek Stupa and Ashokan pillar sanctuary. It represents **Uttar Pradesh's 4th cultural World Heritage Site**.
- **#44: Maratha Military Landscapes of India** (Inscribed in **2025**; covers 12 historic fortifications: 11 in Maharashtra and Gingee Fort in Tamil Nadu).
- **#43: Moidams – Mound-Burial System of the Ahom Dynasty** (Charaideo district, Assam, inscribed in **2024**).
- **#42: Sacred Ensembles of the Hoysalas** (Karnataka — Belur, Halebidu, and Somnathpura, inscribed in **2023**).
- **#41: Santiniketan** (Birbhum district, West Bengal, inscribed in **2023**).
- **#40: Dholavira: A Harappan City** (Kutch district, Gujarat, inscribed in **2021**).
- **#39: Kakatiya Rudreshwara / Ramappa Temple** (Palampet, Mulugu district, Telangana, inscribed in **2021**).
- **Uttar Pradesh Tangible Cultural World Heritage Sites (4 Sites):** 1. **Taj Mahal** (Agra — inscribed in 1983) 2. **Agra Fort** (Agra — inscribed in 1983) 3. **Fatehpur Sikri** (Agra — inscribed in 1986) 4. **Ancient Buddhist Site of Sarnath** (Varanasi district — inscribed in **2026**)
- **Uttarakhand Tangible Natural World Heritage Site (1 Serial Property):**
- **Nanda Devi and Valley of Flowers National Parks** (Chamoli district, inscribed in 1988, expanded in 2005).

> **Important Distinction:** In examination questions, do not quote obsolete counts of 42 or 43 sites, nor limit Uttar Pradesh to only 3 tangible sites following the 2026 inscription of Sarnath. Furthermore, note that the inclusion of **Deepavali** (December 2025) belongs to UNESCO's **Intangible Cultural Heritage (ICH)** list, which is entirely distinct from physical World Heritage monuments.

6. Important Geographical Indications (GI Tags) of UP & UK

State	Product Name & Craft	Category	Distinctive Origin District & Significance
Uttar Pradesh	**Banaras Brocades and Sarees**	Handicraft	Varanasi; renowned globally for rich gold and silver (*Zari*) brocade handloom weaving.

State	Product Name & Craft	Category	Distinctive Origin District & Significance
	Bhadohi Handmade Carpet	Handicraft	Bhadohi (Mirzapur-Bhadohi carpet manufacturing belt); premier woollen hand-knotted carpets.
	Lucknow Chikan Craft	Handicraft	Lucknow; centuries-old delicate white-on-white hand embroidery patronized by Awadh Nawabs.
	Kannauj Perfume (Attar)	Manufactured	Kannauj; acclaimed as the "Perfume Capital of India", distilling natural floral attar in copper stills.
	Moradabad Metal Craft	Handicraft	Moradabad; widely celebrated as *Peetal Nagari* (Brass City) for ornate engraved brassware.
	Firozabad Glassware	Handicraft	Firozabad; known as *Suhag Nagari*, the historic hub of India's glass bangle and glassware industry.
	Aligarh Locks	Manufactured	Aligarh; traditionally designated as *Tala Nagari* (City of Locks) for precision brass and iron locks.
	Gorakhpur Terracotta	Handicraft	Gorakhpur; traditional reddish clay craftsmanship producing distinctive elephant and horse figurines.
	Kalanamak Rice	Agriculture	Siddhartha Nagar and surrounding Terai districts; aromatic black-husked rice associated with Lord Buddha.
	Mahoba Gaura Patthar Hastashilp	Handicraft	Mahoba (Bundelkhand); delicate carving in soft, radiant white pyrophyllite stone.
Uttarakhand	**Berinag Tea**	Agriculture	Pithoragarh district; exquisite, aromatic orthodox Himalayan tea made from wild and cultivated bush leaves.
	Almora Bal Mithai	Food Stuff	Almora; iconic roasted fudge-like sweet made from condensed milk (*khoya*), coated with white sugar globules.
	Uttarakhand Bhotia Dan	Handicraft	Pithoragarh and Chamoli; dense, hand-knotted traditional woollen floor rugs woven by Bhotia tribal women.
	Munsyari White Rajma	Agriculture	Munsyari (Pithoragarh); high-altitude organic kidney beans prized for delicate texture and swift cooking.
	Uttarakhand Ringal Craft	Handicraft	Chamoli and Garhwal hills; flexible Himalayan dwarf bamboo (*Ringal*) woven into baskets, mats, and wares.
	Uttarakhand Aipan Art	Handicraft	Kumaon region; sacred ritual geometric floor and wall art painted with white rice paste over red ochre.
	Uttarakhand Bichhu Buti (Nettle Fabric)	Textile	Chamoli district; eco-friendly natural fiber extracted from wild Himalayan stinging nettle (*Girardinia diversifolia*).
	Jhangora & Manduwa	Agriculture	Mountain districts of Uttarakhand; highly nutritious traditional hill millets (Barnyard Millet and Finger Millet).

7. Folk Paintings of India — State-Wise Master Guide

Traditional Painting Form	State / Region	Key Features, Media & Cultural Significance
Sanjhi	**Uttar Pradesh** (Mathura–Vrindavan / Braj)	An exquisite traditional stencilled **paper-cutting art** practiced along the Yamuna ghats of Mathura and Vrindavan. Traditionally fashioned during Krishna festivals and Pitru Paksha; recognized with an official GI tag.
Aipan	**Uttarakhand** (Kumaon)	A sacred ritual floor and wall art created using white rice-flour paste (*Biswar*) upon an ochre-red background (*Geru*), featuring complex geometric and floral protective motifs. Holds a GI tag.
Madhubani (Mithila Painting)	**Bihar** (Mithila region)	Practiced traditionally by women using natural pigments and brushes made of twigs and nibs; characterized by vivid double-line borders and stylized motifs of deities, nature, and the wedding chamber (*Kohbar*). Holds a GI tag.

Traditional Painting Form	State / Region	Key Features, Media & Cultural Significance
Warli	**Maharashtra** (Thane / Palghar)	An ancient tribal art executed on mud-and-cowdung plastered walls using white pigment made of rice paste and water, depicting community dancing, harvesting, and reverence for the mother goddess *Palaghata*.
Pattachitra	**Odisha** (also practiced in West Bengal)	A traditional scroll painting executed on treated cloth (*Patta*) or dried palm leaves using natural mineral colors, illustrating episodes from the life of Lord Jagannath, Krishna, and Vaishnava legends.
Phad	**Rajasthan** (Bhilwara / Shahpura)	Immense narrative cloth scroll paintings depicting the heroic exploits of folk deities such as Pabuji and Devnarayan, traditionally recited and sung by traveling priest-bards (*Bhopas*).
Gond	**Madhya Pradesh** (Mandla / Dindori)	Celebrated tribal art of the Gond community, characterized by rich textures composed of fine dots, dashes, and rhythmic lines, depicting flora, fauna, and their supreme forest divinity *Bada Dev*.
Kalamkari	**Andhra Pradesh**	Traditional hand-painted and block-printed textile art using natural vegetable dyes and a sharpened bamboo reed (*kalam*). Maintained through two prominent traditions: **Srikalahasti** (freehand temple hangings depicting epics) and **Machilipatnam** (block-printed trade designs).
Pithora	**Gujarat & Madhya Pradesh** (Rathwa & Bhil tribes)	Sacred ritual wall paintings executed inside tribal homes to invoke prosperity and fulfill vows, centered on the consecrated depiction of horses honoring the deity *Pithora Baba*.
Kalighat	**West Bengal** (Kolkata)	A 19th-century urban folk painting style that developed around the Kalighat Kali Temple, renowned for sweeping brush lines and watercolor washes depicting Hindu divinities and satirical caricatures of the colonial elite.
Phulkari	**Punjab**	Traditional folk floral embroidery executed on coarse dyed cotton cloth (*khaddar*) using vibrant untwisted silk threads (*pat*), traditionally gifted during weddings.
Mandana	**Rajasthan & Malwa**	Auspicious geometric floor and wall designs drawn with white chalk (*khadiya*) against red clay plaster to welcome deities and mark domestic festivals.

> **Key Exam Distinction:** Do not confuse **Sanjhi** (indigenous to the Braj region of Uttar Pradesh), **Aipan** (traditional to Kumaon in Uttarakhand), and **Madhubani** (native to Bihar). Each holds a distinct geographical and cultural identity.

8. All 16 UNESCO Intangible Cultural Heritage (ICH) Elements of India

Inscribed on the Representative List of the Intangible Cultural Heritage of Humanity (Ministry of Culture & UNESCO):

#	Year Inscribed	Intangible Cultural Heritage Element	Region / Community	Primary Ritual & Cultural Significance
1	**2008**	**Koodiyattam (Kutiyattam)**	**Kerala**	India's oldest living Sanskrit temple theatre tradition, performed in consecrated theatre halls called *Koothambalams* with the accompaniment of copper *Mizhavu* drums.
2	**2008**	**Ramlila**	**Uttar Pradesh & North India**	The traditional dramatic enactment of the Ramayana during Dussehra, epitomized by the world-famous month-long open-air Ramnagar Ramlila of Varanasi supported by the Kashi Naresh.
3	**2008**	**Tradition of Vedic Chanting**	Pan-India	The uninterrupted oral recitation of sacred Vedic hymns handed down over millennia through sophisticated mnemonic recitation techniques such as *Jatapatha* and *Ghanapatha*.

#	Year Inscribed	Intangible Cultural Heritage Element	Region / Community	Primary Ritual & Cultural Significance
4	**2009**	**Ramman**	**Saloor-Dungra village, Chamoli (Uttarakhand)**	A ritual festival and sacred masked theatre held in honor of the tutelary deity **Bhumiyal Devta**, where villagers perform epic episodes wearing traditional wooden masks.
5	**2010**	**Chhau Dance**	**Jharkhand, West Bengal, Odisha**	A semi-classical martial dance tradition that encompasses three distinct regional streams: **Seraikella** (Jharkhand, masked), **Purulia** (West Bengal, large theatrical masks), and **Mayurbhanj** (Odisha, performed without masks).
6	**2010**	**Kalbelia Folk Songs and Dances**	**Rajasthan**	A sensuous, serpent-like folk dance performed by women of the nomadic Kalbelia snake-charmer community, rhythmically driven by the *Poongi* (been) and *Dhaf*.
7	**2010**	**Mudiyettu**	**Kerala**	A sacred ritual dance-drama performed in Kali temples, dramatizing the mythological battle between the goddess Kali and the demon Darika; preceded by elaborate floor paintings called *Kalam*.
8	**2012**	**Buddhist Chanting of Ladakh**	**Ladakh (Trans-Himalaya)**	The solemn rhythmic chanting of sacred Buddhist texts and philosophical teachings by Mahayana monks (Lamas) of the Gelukpa, Drukpa, and Kagyu monastic lineages.
9	**2013**	**Sankirtana**	**Manipur**	A sacred ritual performance encompassing devotional singing, drumming (*Pung*), and graceful dance, performed by Meitei Vaishnavites to mark life-cycle ceremonies and religious festivals.
10	**2014**	**Traditional Brass and Copper Craft of Utensil Making**	**Jandiala Guru, Amritsar (Punjab)**	The artisanal metal-working technique of hammering heated brass and copper plates into household vessels, practiced traditionally by the hereditary **Thathera** community.
11	**2016**	**Yoga**	Pan-India (Global)	The ancient Indian physical, mental, and spiritual discipline founded upon Patanjali's Ashtanga Yoga; commemorated internationally each year on **21 June**.
12	**2016**	**Nawrouz (Nowruz)**	Parsi & Kashmiri communities	The ancient Persian New Year festival celebrated annually on the vernal equinox (**21 March**), signifying renewal, peace, and the rebirth of nature.
13	**2017**	**Kumbh Mela**	**Prayagraj (UP), Haridwar (UK), Ujjain (MP), Nashik (Maharashtra)**	The largest peaceful religious gathering of pilgrims on Earth, rotating across four sacred river sanctuaries (Ganga, Godavari, and Kshipra) over twelve-year cycles.
14	**2021**	**Durga Puja in Kolkata**	**Kolkata (West Bengal)**	A monumental 10-day autumn festival celebrating the triumph of Goddess Durga over Mahishasura, renowned for extraordinary public art installations, community pandals, and syncretic celebrations.
15	**2023**	**Garba of Gujarat**	**Gujarat**	A devotional, circular community dance performed during the nine nights of Navratri around a perforated earthen lamp (*Garbha Deep*) or an image of Goddess Amba.
16	**2025 (Dec)**	**Deepavali (Festival of Lights)**	Pan-India	Inscribed at the 20th session of the Intergovernmental Committee in December 2025 as India's 16th ICH element, honoring the universal celebration of light over darkness and wisdom over ignorance.

9. Traditional Folk Theatres & Puppetry of India

A. Major Folk Theatres

Folk Theatre Form	State / Region	Key Features, Dramaturgy & Musical Accompaniment
Nautanki	**Uttar Pradesh**	Highly popular operatic folk musical theatre of Northern India; evolved two renowned styles: **Hathras** (emphasizing classical singing) and **Kanpur** (noted for crisp theatrical dialogue). Plays feature verses in *Doha, Chaubola*, and *Chhand* meters accompanied by the thunderous **Nakkara** (kettledrum).
Bhand Pather	**Jammu & Kashmir**	Traditional satirical folk theatre practiced by rural farming communities; blends witty social criticism, parodies, and slapstick comedy with music played on the *Surnai* (shehnai-like reed) and *Dhol*.
Swang / Saang	**Haryana & Western UP**	Dialogue-driven musical folk drama written in rhymed verse; pioneered by celebrated playwrights such as Pt. Deep Chand and Kishan Lal Bhat; staged on open platforms surrounded by spectators.
Rasleela & Ramlila	**Uttar Pradesh** (Mathura–Vrindavan & Ayodhya / Varanasi)	Devotional dance-dramas dramatizing the divine childhood pastimes of Lord Krishna in Braj and the heroic life journey of Lord Rama across Awadh and Varanasi.
Bhavai	**Gujarat & Rajasthan**	Fast-paced socio-religious folk theatre initiated by the 14th-century poet Asaita Thakar; features male actors balancing up to eight earthen pots on their heads while playing the long brass trumpet known as the **Bhungal**.
Jatra	**West Bengal & Odisha**	Open-air musical melodrama that emerged during the Bhakti movement under Chaitanya Mahaprabhu; characterized by grand musical prologues, impassioned dialogues, and high dramatic intensity.
Yakshagana	**Karnataka** (Coastal)	Spectacular traditional theatre based on episodes from the Hindu epics; distinguished by elaborate costumes, towering decorated headdresses (**Muguta**), vivid facial cosmetics, and high athletic leaps.
Therukoothu	**Tamil Nadu**	Traditional rural street theatre performed in village squares, historically centered on the annual festival worship of Draupadi Amman.
Koodiyattam	**Kerala**	Classical Sanskrit temple drama recognized as a UNESCO ICH masterpiece; features stylized hand gestures (*Mudras*) and highly sophisticated eye movements accompanied by *Mizhavu* drums.
Ankiya Nat / Bhaona	**Assam**	One-act Vaishnavite devotional plays created by **Srimanta Sankardeva**; composed in the literary language *Brajavali* and traditionally staged in monastic assembly halls (**Namghars**).
Tamasha	**Maharashtra**	Energetic, fast-paced secular folk theatre that evolved in military camps; combines satirical comedy, witty banter, and lively *Lavani* dance accompanied by the *Dholki*.
Dashavatar	**Konkan / Goa / Maharashtra**	Traditional temple folk theatre depicting the ten divine incarnations of Lord Vishnu, widely performed during local harvest festivities.

B. Traditional Indian Puppetry (Four Master Traditions)

Puppetry Form	Traditional Name	State of Origin	Key Construction & Manipulation Features
String Puppets	**Kathputli**	**Rajasthan**	Carved from a single block of mango wood and dressed in vibrant medieval Rajasthani garments; manipulated with strings, while the puppeteer produces sharp whistling voices using a reed whistle called a *Boli*.
	Kundhei	**Odisha**	Made of lightweight wood with long flowing skirts and no articulated legs; movements are closely attuned to the rhythms of Odissi music.
	Gombeyatta	**Karnataka**	Highly stylized wooden puppets modeled directly upon the elaborate costumes, headdresses, and characters of **Yakshagana** theatre.

Puppetry Form	Traditional Name	State of Origin	Key Construction & Manipulation Features
	Bommalattam	**Tamil Nadu**	Combines mechanisms of **both rod and string puppetry**; represents the largest, heaviest, and most mechanically complex puppets in India, operated via a cloth ring worn on the puppeteer's head.
Shadow Puppets	**Tholu Bommalata**	**Andhra Pradesh**	Translucent leather puppets painted in glowing vegetable colors on both sides; projected against a backlit white cloth screen.
	Togalu Gombeyatta	**Karnataka**	Small, delicate leather shadow figures depicting epic scenes, operated behind an illuminated white screen.
	Ravanachhaya	**Odisha**	Made from opaque deerskin; **casts purely black-and-white shadows** on the screen without color projections and has no articulated joints, producing dramatic silhouetted forms.
Glove Puppets	**Pavakoothu**	**Kerala**	Worn directly over the puppeteer's hand; intricately modeled with carved wooden heads and painted costumes inspired directly by **Kathakali** makeup and crowns.
Rod Puppets	**Putul Nach**	**West Bengal**	Heavy wooden dolls sculpted with shoulder joints; manipulated from beneath the stage by puppeteers holding sturdy control rods.
	Yampuri	**Bihar**	Carved entirely from single pieces of wood without joints; specifically dramatizes moral tales set in the court of Yama, the God of Death.

10. Martial Arts of India

Martial Art Form	State of Origin	Key Weapons, Principles & Distinctive Features
Kalaripayattu	**Kerala**	Celebrated as the **oldest living martial art in the world** (mythologically attributed to Sage Parashurama); practiced within a sacred subterranean earthen arena (*Kalari*). Employs strikes, grappling, and traditional weapons including the deadly flexible whip-sword (**Urumi**), staff, and buckler.
Silambam	**Tamil Nadu**	An ancient staff-fencing martial art referenced in Sangam literature such as the *Silappadikaram*; utilizes a 1.68-metre rapid-spinning **bamboo staff** (*Silambam*) to deflect attacks and strike vulnerable targets.
Thang-Ta & Sarit Sarak	**Manipur**	The traditional combat system of Meitei warriors; **Thang-Ta** emphasizes armed warfare (**Thang** = sword, **Ta** = spear), while **Sarit Sarak** comprises unarmed hand-to-hand combat and evasion.
Gatka	**Punjab**	Traditional Sikh martial art codified under the patronage of the sixth Sikh Guru, **Guru Hargobind Ji**; practitioners utilize wooden training swords (*Gatka*) and leather target shields, prominently demonstrated during the Hola Mohalla festival.
Pari-Khanda	**Bihar**	Created historically by Rajput warriors; utilizes the shield (**Pari**) and two-edged sword (**Khanda**); its footwork patterns and athletic steps form the foundational physical vocabulary of **Chhau dance**.
Thoda	**Himachal Pradesh**	A traditional martial sport rooted in **archery** that traces its lineage to the Mahabharata; practiced during Baisakhi in the Kullu and Shimla hills, where competing archers aim blunt arrows strictly at their opponents' legs below the knees.
Mallakhamb	**Madhya Pradesh & Maharashtra**	An extraordinary traditional gymnastic martial discipline in which athletes perform dynamic aerial yoga postures and acrobatic maneuvers on a vertical polished teak pole or a hanging cotton rope; declared the **State Sport of Madhya Pradesh**.
Musti-Yuddha	**Varanasi (Uttar Pradesh)**	Ancient traditional unarmed Indian pugilism and bare-knuckle boxing utilizing punches, elbow strikes, and grappling maneuvers.
Mardani Khel	**Maharashtra** (Kolhapur)	A historic Maratha armed martial art emphasizing agility, swordplay with the flexible gauntlet-sword (**Patta**), and defense using the bamboo staff (*Kathi*).

Martial Art Form	State of Origin	Key Weapons, Principles & Distinctive Features
Kuttu Varisai	**Tamil Nadu**	Traditional Dravidian unarmed martial art focusing on rapid footwork, devastating animal-style strikes, and knowledge of vital pressure points (**Varma Kalai**).

11. Hindustani Classical Music Gharanas & Leading Exponents

Gharana	Founders & Historical Pioneers	Key Stylistic Characteristics & Aesthetics	Renowned Maestros & Legendary Exponents
Gwalior Gharana	**Nathan Pir Bakhsh**, **Hassu Khan**, **Haddu Khan**	Acknowledged as the **oldest and foundational Khayal gharana**; characterized by an unadorned, noble, open-throated singing style (*Aakaar*), balanced exposition of the raga, and systematic note expansion.	Vishnu Digambar Paluskar, Pt. Omkarnath Thakur, D.V. Paluskar, Malini Rajurkar, Neela Bhagwat
Agra Gharana	**Haji Sujan Khan**, **Khuda Bakhsh**; revitalized by **Ustad Faiyaz Khan**	Famously known as the **"Rangeela Gharana"**; marked by a robust, deep, resonant voice culture that masterfully infuses classical Khayal with ancient Dhrupad-Dhamar *Nom-Tom* alap elements.	Ustad Faiyaz Khan, Vilayat Hussain Khan, Shrikrishna Narayan Ratanjankar, Khadim Hussain Khan
Kirana Gharana	**Ustad Abdul Karim Khan**, **Ustad Abdul Wahid Khan** (originating from Kirana, Shamli district, UP)	Distinguished by deep emotional resonance, supreme tonal purity (*Sur*), and leisurely, contemplative note-by-note melodic evolution (**Vilambit Khayal**).	**Pt. Bhimsen Joshi**, Gangubai Hangal, Sawai Gandharva, Prabha Atre, Hirabai Barodekar
Jaipur-Atrauli Gharana	**Ustad Alladiya Khan**	Celebrated for complex, rare, and compound ragas (*Jod Ragas*); distinguished by intricate, spiral rhythmic phrasing (*Taans*) executed in an offbeat, asymmetrical swing across challenging talas.	**Kishori Amonkar**, Kesarbai Kerkar, Mogubai Kurdikar, Mallikarjun Mansur, Shruti Sadolikar
Patiala Gharana	**Ustad Fateh Ali Khan** and **Ustad Ali Bakhsh Khan** ("Alia-Fattu")	Known for dynamic, lightning-fast cascade passages (*Taans*), expressive emotional embellishments, and seamless mastery over both classical Khayal and romantic semiclassical **Thumri**.	**Ustad Bade Ghulam Ali Khan**, Begum Akhtar, Parveen Sultana, Jagjit Singh, Ajoy Chakrabarty
Banaras Gharana (Vocal & Instrumental)	**Pt. Ram Sahai** (Tabla pioneer), **Thakur Prasad** (Kathak pioneer)	Celebrated worldwide for its unparalleled mastery over the **Tabla**, **Sarangi**, and **Shehnai**, as well as soul-stirring semiclassical vocal forms including **Thumri, Dadra, Chaiti, and Kajri**.	**Ustad Bismillah Khan** (Shehnai — Bharat Ratna), **Pt. Kishan Maharaj** (Tabla), **Pt. Samta Prasad / Gudai Maharaj** (Tabla), **Girija Devi** (Queen of Thumri), Siddheshwari Devi, Rajan & Sajan Mishra

Topic 1 — Institutions Related to Indian Culture

Consolidated — 34 Must-Score Facts

1. The **Asiatic Society of Bengal** was founded in **1784** at Calcutta by **Sir William Jones. Warren Hastings** declined the Presidentship in Jones's favour.
2. **Fort William College** was set up in **1800** by **Lord Wellesley** to train Company officers in Indian languages.
3. **Sanskrit College, Calcutta** opened in **1824. Benares Sanskrit College** was founded by **Jonathan Duncan** in **1791** and must not be confused with the Asiatic Society.
4. The **Bhandarkar Oriental Research Institute** at Pune was founded in **1917** and is known for critical editions such as the Mahabharata.
5. A **gurukul** (गुरुकुल) is a residential guru–shishya school. **Guru dakshina** (गुरु दक्षिणा) is an end-of-study offering, not a monthly fee.
6. Classical learning counted **18 Vidyas** and **64 Kalas**. The ashrama order is **Brahmacharya** (ब्रह्मचर्य) → **Grihastha** (गृहस्थ) → **Vanaprastha** (वानप्रस्थ) → **Sannyasa** (संन्यास).
7. **Kangri Gurukul** at Haridwar was founded in **1902** by **Swami Shraddhanand** in the Dayananda / Arya Samaj line.
8. **Nalanda** (नालंदा) mahavihara in Bihar flourished under Pala patronage. **Hiuen Tsang** (ह्वेनसांग) studied there. It was destroyed around **1193** by Bakhtiyar Khilji. The ruins are UNESCO **2016** under the **ASI**.
9. The **new Nalanda University** is under the **MEA** by the Act of **2010**, with campus at **Rajgir**. It is not a Culture Ministry body.
10. **Taxila (Takshashila)** lay in Gandhara, now in **Pakistan**. It was a multi-teacher city linked with **Panini** (पाणिनि) and **Chanakya** (चाणक्य), and is UNESCO **1980**.
11. **Vikramashila** (विक्रमशिला) at Bhagalpur was founded by Pala **Dharmapala. Atisha** taught there. It fell around **1203** to Khilji and is **not** a separate World Heritage site.
12. The **Indian Museum**, Kolkata (**1814**) is India's oldest museum. The **National Museum**, Delhi dates to **1949**.
13. Landmark museums outside Delhi–Kolkata include **Salar Jung** (Hyderabad, **1951**), **Victoria Memorial** (Kolkata, **1921**), **CSMVS / Prince of Wales** (Mumbai, **1922**), and the **Calico Museum of Textiles** (Ahmedabad, **1949**).
14. The **Archaeological Survey of India** was founded in **1861** under **Alexander Cunningham**. The **National Archives of India** began in **1891**.
15. Monument protection runs under the **AMASR Act 1958** (amended **2010**). The **National Monument Authority** regulates a **100 m** prohibited zone and a **200 m** regulated zone around centrally protected monuments.
16. **Sangeet Natak Akademi** (संगीत नाटक अकादेमी) (**1952**) covers performing arts. **Sahitya Akademi** and **Lalit Kala Akademi** (ललित कला अकादेमी) both date to **1954** for literature and visual arts.
17. **Sahitya Akademi** awards in **24** languages. **Jnanpith** (ज्ञानपीठ) (**1965**) is a Bharatiya Jnanpith trust prize, not a Sahitya Akademi award.
18. **IGNCA** and the **Ministry of Culture** date to **1985**. **CCRT** began in **1979**. **NGMA** dates to **1954**. The **National School of Drama (NSD)** was founded in **1959** at New Delhi.
19. **Kalakshetra** at Chennai, founded by **Rukmini Devi Arundale**, is the premier Bharatanatyam and arts academy. **INTACH** (**1984**) is an **NGO** for heritage conservation, not a Culture ministry akademi.
20. **ICCR** (Indian Council for Cultural Relations, **1950**) belongs to the **MEA**, not the Culture Ministry.
21. India has **seven Zonal Cultural Centres** (about **1985–87**) under Culture for folk and tribal promotion. The **North Central ZCC** headquarters is at **Prayagraj** (प्रयागराज).
22. Important museums in Uttar Pradesh include the **Allahabad Museum** (Prayagraj, **1931**), the State Museum at Lucknow, the Government Museum at Jhansi, and the **Sarnath** (सारनाथ) ASI site museum.
23. ASI circles for key UP monuments run through **Lucknow** (लखनऊ) and **Agra** (आगरा), covering Sarnath, Kushinagar, Taj, and Fatehpur Sikri.
24. IVC sites in UP include **Alamgirpur** (आलमगीरपुर), **Mandi** (मंडी), and **Hulas. Rakhigarhi** is in Haryana, not UP.

25. Lalit Kala has a regional centre at **Lucknow**. IGNCA has a regional centre at **Varanasi** (वाराणसी). **Bhartendu Natya Academy** (Lucknow, **1975**) trains theatre on an NSD-style model.
26. **HRIDAY** (**2015**) includes **Varanasi. PRASAD** is a **Tourism** ministry scheme, not Culture.
27. The **National Culture Fund** began in **1996. Ek Bharat Shreshtha Bharat** began in **2015**.
28. The **National Mission for Manuscripts** (**2003**) was restructured as **Gyan Bharatam** for **2024–31**.
29. **Odantapuri** and **Somapura** (Paharpur, Bangladesh) are Pala-age Buddhist centres often paired with Nalanda and Vikramashila; Somapura is UNESCO, not a UP site.
30. The **Raja Rammohun Roy Library Foundation** (Kolkata) and the **National Library** (Kolkata) anchor national library policy under Culture, distinct from the akademis.
31. **Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj Vastu Sangrahalaya (CSMVS)** is Mumbai's former Prince of Wales Museum. Do not place Salar Jung in Delhi or Mumbai.
32. Site museums such as **Sarnath** and **Kushinagar** are ASI excavation museums. They are not the same as the National Museum, Delhi.
33. **ICCR** does cultural diplomacy abroad. The seven **ZCCs** do regional folk outreach inside India. Do not swap MEA vs Culture parentage.
34. Protected-monument status under AMASR is national legal protection. UNESCO World Heritage listing is a separate international inscription.

📋 Must-score facts — societies, colleges, museums

Institution ↔ year / founder

Institution	Correct
Asiatic Society of Bengal	**1784**, Calcutta; **William Jones** (Hastings declined presidency)
Fort William College	**1800**; **Wellesley**
Benares Sanskrit College	**1791**; **Jonathan Duncan**
Sanskrit College, Calcutta	**1824**
Bhandarkar O.R.I., Pune	**1917**
Kangri Gurukul, Haridwar	**1902**; Dayananda / Arya Samaj line
Indian Museum, Kolkata	**1814** — India's oldest museum
National Museum, Delhi	**1949**

Learning / mahavihara tags

Item	Correct
Gurukul	Residential guru–shishya; dakshina ≠ monthly fee
18 Vidyas / 64 Kalas	Classical learning counts
Ashrama order	Brahmacharya → Grihastha → Vanaprastha → Sannyasa
Nalanda	Pala Bihar; Hiuen Tsang; destroyed ~1193
New Nalanda University	**MEA**, Act **2010**, campus **Rajgir** (≠ Culture Ministry)
Taxila	Gandhara / **Pakistan**; Panini–Chanakya link
Vikramashila	Bhagalpur; **Dharmapala** (धर्मपाल); Atisha; fell ~1203

Topic 2 — Religious and Philosophical Traditions

Consolidated Must-Score Facts

1. The six **Astika** (आस्तिक) schools that accept the Veda as pramana (प्रमाण) are **Nyaya–Gautama** (न्याय - गौतम), **Vaisheshika–Kanada** (वैशेषिक - कणाद), **Samkhya–Kapila** (सांख्य - कपिल), **Yoga–Patanjali** (योग - पतंजलि), **Mimamsa–Jaimini** (मीमांसा - जैमिनि), and **Vedanta–Badarayana** (वेदांत - बादरायण).
2. The usual **Nastika** (नास्तिक) set is **Charvaka** (चार्वाक), **Buddhism** (बौद्ध धर्म), and **Jainism** (जैन धर्म). Add **Ajivika** (**Makkhali Gosala**) [आजीवक - मक्खलि गोसाल] when fate / *niyati* (नियति) appears in options.
3. **Nyaya** (न्याय) is logic and epistemology with four pramanas (प्रमाण). **Vaisheshika** (वैशेषिक) is atomism (*paramanu* / परमाणु). This Gautama is **not** the Buddha.
4. **Samkhya** (सांख्य) is dualist Purusha–Prakriti (पुरुष-प्रकृति) with **25** tattvas (तत्त्व) and is classically **nirishvara** (निरीश्वरवाद). **Yoga** (योग) is its practical partner and adds **Ishvara** (ईश्वर).
5. **Ashtanga Yoga** (अष्टांग योग) order is **yama** (यम), **niyama** (नियम), **asana** (आसन), **pranayama** (प्राणायाम), **pratyahara** (प्रत्याहार), **dharana** (धारणा), **dhyana** (ध्यान), **samadhi** (समाधि).
6. **Purva Mimamsa** (पूर्व मीमांसा - Jaimini) treats Vedic **ritual** (कर्मकाण्ड). **Uttara Mimamsa / Vedanta** (उत्तर मीमांसा / वेदांत - Badarayana) treats the Upanishads. Kapila is **not** Vedanta.
7. **Shankara** taught **Advaita** (अद्वैतवाद). **Ramanuja** taught **Vishishtadvaita** (विशिष्टद्वैतवाद). **Madhva** taught **Dvaita** (द्वैतवाद). **Nimbarka** taught **Dvaitadvaita** (द्वैताद्वैतवाद). **Vallabha** taught **Shuddhadvaita** (शुद्धाद्वैतवाद).
8. Adi Shankara established four cardinal monastic centres (mathas) associated with the four Vedas: **Sringeri** (South — Yajurveda), **Dwaraka** (West — Samaveda), **Puri** (पुरी) (East — Rigveda), and **Jyotirmath / Badrinath** (North — Atharvaveda).
9. Vedic stack order is **Samhita** → **Brahmana** → **Aranyaka** → **Upanishad**. *Tat tvam asi* is from the **Chandogya** Upanishad. **Brahman** is not the same word as **Brahmin**.
10. Buddha's life geography is **Lumbini** (birth), **Bodh Gaya** (बोधगया) in Bihar (enlightenment), **Sarnath** in UP (first sermon), and **Kushinagar** (कुशीनगर) in UP (death).
11. Buddhist councils order is **Rajagriha** → **Vaishali** → **Pataliputra** → **Kundalvana**. *Milindapanha* (मिलिंदपन्ह) is dialogue of **Menander / Milinda** with **Nagasena** (नागसेन).
12. **Theravada** (थेरवाद) aims at the arhat and uses Pali. **Mahayana** (महायान) aims at the Bodhisattva and uses Sanskrit.
13. Jainism has **24** Tirthankaras. Key emblems include the **bull** for Rishabhanatha, the **serpent hood** for Parshvanatha, and the **lion** (सिंह) for Mahavira. Important Nirvana sites include **Ashtapad**, **Sammed Shikharji**, and **Pavapuri** (पावापुरी).
14. **Parshva** taught four vows. **Mahavira** added **Brahmacharya** (ब्रह्मचर्य) as the fifth. The Svetambara canon has **12 Angas**.
15. **Digambara** monks are sky-clad and deny women monks. **Svetambara** (श्वेताम्बर) monks wear white and admit women monks.
16. **Anekantavada** (अनेकांतवाद) is many-sided reality. **Syadvada** (स्याद्वाद) is the seven-fold "syad" speech about that reality.
17. Bhakti chronology often runs **Namdev** → **Kabir** → **Nanak** → **Chaitanya. Kabir** was a disciple of **Ramananda. Surdas** belongs to **Vallabha**'s line. **Tulsidas** (तुलसीदास) wrote in **Awadhi**.
18. The southern Tamil Bhakti tradition flourished through the **12 Alvars** (Vaishnava poet-saints, with Andal as the sole woman saint) and the **63 Nayanars** (Shaiva poet-saints). The four revered Samayacharyas are **Appar, Sambandar, Sundarar, and Manikkavachakar**.
19. **Chishti** Sufis at Ajmer / Delhi favour **sama** (समा / महफ़िल-ए-समा) and qawwali (क़व्वाली). **Suhrawardi** is linked with Multan. **Nizamuddin Auliya** belongs to **Delhi**.
20. *Fawaid-ul-Fuad* records Nizamuddin's conversations as compiled by **Amir Hasan Sijzi. Wahdat-ul-wujud** (वहदत-उल-वुजूद - Ibn Arabi) is not the same as **wahdat-ush-shuhud** (वहदत-उश-शुहूद - Sirhindi).

21. Among the ten Sikh Gurus, **Angad** gave **Gurmukhi**, **Arjan** compiled the **Adi Granth** (आदि ग्रंथ), and **Gobind Singh** founded the **Khalsa** (खालसा) in **1699**.
22. The five Sikh Takhts are **Akal Takht**, **Keshgarh Sahib**, **Damdama Sahib**, **Patna Sahib**, and **Hazur Sahib**.
23. Pramana count traps: **Charvaka** accepts only one, **Nyaya** accepts four, and Mimamsa–Kumarila / Vedanta often accept **six**.
24. The core Buddhist pilgrimage circuit in Uttar Pradesh comprises **Sarnath**, **Kushinagar**, **Shravasti**, **Sankisa**, and **Kaushambi** (कौशांबी). The national emblem (Lion Capital) is from Sarnath.
25. Major Hindu and Bhakti heritage centres in Uttar Pradesh include **Kashi**, **Ayodhya** (अयोध्या), the **Braj** region of Surdas, the **Prayagraj Kumbh**, and Kabir's memorial shrine (*samadhi*) at **Maghar**.
26. **Kumbh Mela** is UNESCO **intangible** heritage (**2017**). It is not a monument World Heritage site.
27. The white marble dargah of Sheikh Salim Chishti at **Fatehpur Sikri** (फतेहपुर सीकरी) is the preeminent Mughal-era Sufi pilgrimage site in Uttar Pradesh.
28. The mound of **Kankali Tila** at Mathura is the landmark Uttar Pradesh archaeological site for ancient Jain art and inscriptions.

📋 Must-score facts — Darshanas, Vedanta, Buddhism

Astika six (accept Veda)

School	Founder / tag
Nyaya	**Gautama** — logic (≠ Buddha)
Vaisheshika	**Kanada** — atomism
Samkhya	**Kapila** — Purusha–Prakriti; 25 tattvas; classically nirishvara
Yoga	**Patanjali** (पतंजलि) — practical partner of Samkhya
Purva Mimamsa	**Jaimini** — Vedic ritual
Uttara Mimamsa / Vedanta	**Badarayana** — Upanishads

Nastika / Yoga / Vedanta

Item	Correct
Nastika set	Charvaka, Buddhism, Jainism (+ Ajivika / Gosala)
Ashtanga Yoga order	yama → niyama → asana → pranayama → pratyahara → dharana → dhyana → samadhi
Shankara / Ramanuja / Madhva	Advaita / Vishishtadvaita / Dvaita
Shankara mathas	Sringeri–Yajur · Dwaraka–Sama · Puri–Rig · Badri–Atharva
Vedic stack	Samhita → Brahmana → Aranyaka → Upanishad

Buddhism quick

Item	Correct
Life geography	Lumbini → Bodh Gaya → **Sarnath** → **Kushinagar**
Councils	Rajagriha → Vaishali → Pataliputra → Kundalvana
Theravada / Mahayana	Arhat + Pali / Bodhisattva + Sanskrit
Milindapanha	Menander–**Nagasena**

Topic 3 — Indian Architecture

Consolidated Must-Score Facts

1. **Nagara** (नागर शैली) temples have a curvilinear **shikhara** (शिखर) and generally no monumental gopuram.
2. **Dravida** (द्रविड़ शैली) temples have a pyramidal **vimana** (विमान) and a tall **gopuram** (गोपुरम).
3. **Vesara** (वेसर शैली) is the Deccan hybrid of Chalukya and Hoysala land.
4. The temple sequence runs **garbhagriha** (गर्भगृह) to **antarala** (अंतराल) to **mandapa** (मंडप), with **pradakshina** (प्रदक्षिणा पथ) around the sanctum.
5. An **amalaka** (आमलक) and a **kalasha** (कलश) crown a Nagara tower.
6. A **gopuram** is a Dravida **gateway**. A **shikhara** is the Nagara **sanctum** tower. These two words are often swapped. Pandya and Nayaka phases make gopurams the dominant outer face.
7. The Odisha Nagara order is **Parasuramesvara** (परशुरामेश्वर), then **Mukteshvara** (मुक्तेश्वर), then **Lingaraja**, then **Jagannath** (जगन्नाथ), then **Konark** (कोणार्क).
8. A **rekha deul** (रेखा देउल) is the Odisha sanctum tower. A **pidha deul** (पीढ़ा देउल) is the jagamohana hall. **Lingaraja** is the tallest standing temple in Bhubaneswar, about **180** feet.
9. **Konark** Sun Temple is a stone chariot of Surya with **24** wheels and **7** horses. Eastern Ganga **Narasimhadeva I** built it in the **13th** century. It is also called the **Black Pagoda**.
10. **Khajuraho** (खजुराहो) is a **Chandela** sandstone Nagara group in **Madhya Pradesh**, built in the **10th–12th** centuries. About **85** shrines were planned. About **25** still stand. Groups are Hindu and Jain.
11. **Kandariya Mahadeva** (कंदरिया महादेव), built by **Vidyadhara**, is the largest Khajuraho temple. **Matangeshvara** belongs to **Dhanga's** age.
12. **Markandeshwar** in Vidarbha is called the **Khajuraho of Vidarbha**. It is not Kailasa. It is not Bhimashankar.
13. **Modhera** (मोढेरा) Sun Temple belongs to Solanki **Bhima I**.
14. **Dilwara** (दिलवाड़ा) at Mount Abu is white **marble** Jain work of the same Solanki milieu.
15. **Rani ki Vav** (रानी की वाव) at Patan is a Solanki stepwell. UNESCO listed it in **2014**.
16. Pallava phases run **Mahendra** rock-cut mandapas, then **Mamalla** rathas, then **Rajasimha** structural temples such as the Shore Temple and Kailasanatha. **Draupadi ratha** is the **smallest**.
17. Chola Dravida peaks are **Brihadeeswara** at Thanjavur (**1010**, granite), **Gangaikonda Cholapuram** (गंगैकोंड चोलपुरम), and **Airavatesvara** (एरावतेश्वर) at Darasuram. Early Chola **Korangnath** at Srinivasanallur belongs to **Parantaka I**.
18. **Aihole** (ऐहोल) is the cradle of early Chalukya experiment. The **Lad Khan** temple stands there.
19. **Badami** has four caves. **Pattadakal** (पट्टदकल) mixes Nagara and Dravida. Hoysala Belur, Halebidu, and Somnathpur use soapstone star plans in the **Vesara** hybrid.
20. The **Sarnath** (सारनाथ) Ashokan capital has four lions. **Rampurva** has a bull and a lion. **Sankisa** has an elephant. **Vaishali** (वैशाली) has a single lion. The stone is **Chunar** (चुनार) with Mauryan polish.
21. **Sanchi** has four **toranas** (तोरण). **Bharhut** is a Shunga railing campus. **Amaravati** (अमरावती) has ayaka platforms. **Dhamek** is at Sarnath. **Mahabodhi** (महाबोधि) is at Bodh Gaya.
22. A **stupa** (स्तूप) is a solid relic mound. A **chaitya** (चैत्य) is a congregational prayer hall with an apse stupa. A **vihara** (विहार) is a monastic residence.
23. **Karle** (कार्ले) is the largest surviving chaitya. Ajanta chaitya caves are **9, 10, 19, and 26**. **Kanheri** (कन्हेरी) holds more than **100** Buddhist caves on Mumbai's western fringe.
24. **Lomas Rishi** (लोमश ऋषि) is a Barabar cave. **Ajanta** (अजंता) is Buddhist only.
25. **Ellora** (एलोरा) caves **1–12** are Buddhist, **13–29** are Hindu, and **30–34** are Jain. **Kailasa** (कैलास) is cave **16**, cut under **Krishna I** in Dravida rock-cut form.
26. **Elephanta** (एलिफेंटा) is mainly **Shaiva**, with the Trimurti, under Rashtrakuta-age patronage. A smaller Buddhist group also exists.

27. The Slave house begins **Qutub**. The Khilji house adds **Alai Darwaza** (अलाई दरवाज़ा). Tughlaq walls use a sloping **batter**. Sharqi work is at **Jaunpur** (जौनपुर). **Adina** mosque is at **Pandua**, not Mandu.
28. Babur's tomb is at **Kabul**. Humayun's tomb is at **Delhi**. Akbar's red stone city is **Fatehpur Sikri**. Jahangir's tomb is at **Lahore**. **Itimad-ud-Daulah** (इतिमाद-उद-दौला) is Nur Jahan's marble tomb at Agra. Shah Jahan built the **Taj** and the **Red Fort**. Aurangzeb's **Bibi ka Maqbara** (बीबी का मकबरा) is at Aurangabad.
29. **Buland Darwaza** (बुलंद दरवाज़ा) commemorates Akbar's **Gujarat** victory. It is not a monument for Jahangir's birth.
30. Uttar Pradesh World Heritage cultural sites are the **Taj Mahal** (ताज महल) (**1983**), **Agra Fort** (आगरा किला) (**1983**), **Fatehpur Sikri** (**1986**), and **Sarnath** (**2026**).
31. Uttar Pradesh architecture also includes the Gupta brick temple at **Bhitargaon** (भीतरगाँव), Gupta remains at **Garhwa** in Prayagraj, Sharqi monuments of **Jaunpur**, and the teerth of **Naimisharanya** (नैमिषारण्य) at Sitapur.
32. These are **not** in Uttar Pradesh: Qutub and Humayun's tomb (Delhi), Khajuraho and Sanchi (Madhya Pradesh), Konark (Odisha), Ajanta, Ellora, and Elephanta (Maharashtra), and Mahabalipuram (Tamil Nadu).
33. Indo-Islamic building uses the **true arch** and dome. Pre-Islamic temples often used **corbelled** courses instead.
34. **Charbagh** (चारबाग़) is the Islamic four-part garden plan. **Panchayatana** (पंचायतन शैली) is the Hindu five-shrine plan with a central sanctum and four corner shrines.
35. Gupta **Dashavatara** (दशावतार) at **Deogarh** (देवगढ़) is a classic early panchayatana temple. Freestanding structural temples begin in the **Gupta** (गुप्त) age.
36. **Martand** (मार्तंड) Sun Temple of Lalitaditya in Kashmir belongs with Konark and Modhera as a sun temple. It is not a latina Nagara shrine of the Gangetic plain.
37. **Morena Chausath Yogini**, built by Kachchhapaghata **Devapala**, is a circular hypaethral temple. It is not the Khajuraho Chausath Yogini. Popular belief links its plan to the Indian Parliament building. It is not India's only circular temple.
38. **Palitana** (पालिताना) Jain temples stand on **Shatrunjaya** hill near Bhavnagar in Gujarat. The main dedication is to **Adinatha**.
39. **Sonagiri** near **Datia** in Madhya Pradesh is a Digambar Jain hill of about **103** temples. Main shrine number 57 honours **Chandraprabhu**.
40. The Jagannath triad at Puri — Jagannath, Balabhadra, and Subhadra — is of **neem wood**, renewed in the nabakalebara cycle.
41. **Angkor Wat** in Cambodia was built by Khmer **Suryavarman II** for **Vishnu**. **Borobudur** on Java in Indonesia is a UNESCO Buddhist monument.
42. **Virupaksha** (विरूपाक्ष) at **Hampi** (हम्पी) is a living Vijayanagara Shiva shrine. Do not confuse it with **Virupaksha** at **Pattadakal**.
43. **Teli ka Mandir** at Gwalior mixes a **Dravida-type** tower with northern ornament. Treat it as a fusion trap.
44. Among Arasavalli, Amarkantak, and Omkareshwar, only **Arasavalli** in Andhra is the famous **Sun** temple. The other two are Shiva centres.
45. **Ellora** is not Saka. **Meenakshi** is Nayaka Madurai, not Pallava. **Mahabalipuram** (महाबलीपुरम) is Pallava, not Rashtrakuta. The **Besnagar Heliodorus** pillar is a **Vaishnava Garuda**, not a Shaiva cave.
46. **Sittanavasal** (सित्तन्नवासल) is a **Jain** cave shrine of Pallava age. Ajanta is Buddhist. Full mural detail lives in the Painting chapter.
47. The Madhya Pradesh World Heritage trio often tested together is **Khajuraho**, **Bhimbetka** (भीमबेटका), and **Sanchi**. **Mandu** (मांडू) is not a World Heritage Site.
48. Ajanta's other Gupta-age mural cousin is **Bagh** in Madhya Pradesh. Padmapani in Cave 1 is taught fully in Painting.
49. Rashtrakuta courts also backed Jain scholars. **Amoghavarsha I** was a disciple of **Jinasena**, author of the *Adipurana*. That is context for Ellora's Jain caves.
50. The south-temple chronology is **Sapt Pagoda**, then **Shore Temple** (शोर मंदिर), then **Brihadeeswara**, then **Gangaikonda Cholapuram**.

📋 Must-score drill — Nagara, Dravida, temples, pillars

Style

Style	Correct
Nagara	Curvilinear **shikhara**; generally **no** monumental gopuram
Dravida	Pyramidal **vimana**; monumental **gopuram** gateway
Sequence	Garbhagriha → antarala → mandapa (plus pradakshina)
Trap	Gopuram is not a shikhara

Temple, dynasty, and place

Temple / set	Correct
Odisha order	Parasuramesvara → Mukteshvara → Lingaraja → Jagannath → **Konark**
Konark	Stone chariot; **24** wheels, **7** horses; Narasimhadeva I
Khajuraho	**Chandela**, Madhya Pradesh; sandstone Nagara
Modhera / Dilwara	Solanki Gujarat; Dilwara is **marble** at Mount Abu
Pallava phases	Mahendra rock-cut → Mamalla rathas → Rajasimha structural
Chola peaks	Brihadeeswara **1010** · Gangaikonda · Airavatesvara
Aihole / Badami / Pattadakal	Early Chalukya cradle · four caves · mixed styles

Ashokan pillars

Site	Capital
Sarnath	Four lions
Rampurva	Bull / lion
Sankisa	Elephant
Vaishali	Single lion

Topic 4 — Indian Painting

Consolidated — 32 Must-Score Facts

1. **Bhimbetka** (भीमबेटका) rock shelters are in Raisen, **Madhya Pradesh. V.S. Wakankar** demonstrated their prehistoric importance in **1957**. They are UNESCO **2003**, not fresco.
2. The **Jogimara** (जोगीमारा) cave at Ramgarh in **Chhattisgarh**, dating to about the **3rd–1st** century BCE, contains the earliest surviving Indian frescoes, depicting secular dance and theatrical scenes rather than Buddhist narrative cycles.
3. **Mirzapur–Sonbhadra** holds the main **UP** prehistoric rock-art belt. **Bagh** caves are in **Madhya Pradesh**, not UP.
4. The **Shadanga** six limbs are **Rupabheda** (रूपभेद), **Pramanam** (प्रमाणम्) (proportion), **Bhava** (भाव) (emotion), **Lavanyam** (grace), **Sadrisyam** (likeness), and **Varnikabhangam** (वर्णिकाभंगम्) (colour and brush).
5. Ajanta is famous for **paintings**. Ellora is famous for **sculpture**, especially Kailasa. Do not swap the two.
6. Ajanta Cave **1** holds Padmapani and Vajrapani. Cave **16** holds the Dying Princess / Mahajanaka theme. Cave **17** holds Vessantara. Rediscovery is linked to **John Smith** in **1819**.
7. Other celebrated mural sites across India include **Bagh** in Madhya Pradesh, **Badami** (बादामी) in Karnataka, the Jain cave of **Sittanavasal** in Tamil Nadu, **Brihadeeswara** (बृहदीश्वर) Chola frescoes at Thanjavur, **Lepakshi** in Andhra Pradesh, traditional Kerala temple murals, and the Himalayan Buddhist wall paintings at **Alchi and Tabo**.
8. Emperor Akbar's imperial atelier produced major illustrated manuscript projects including the **Hamzanama** (हम्ज़ानामा) (an adventure cycle painted on cloth across ~1,400 folios), the **Tuti-nama**, and the Persian Mahabharata (**Razmnama** (रज्मनामा)), led by master painters such as **Daswanth** and **Basawan**.
9. Emperor Jahangir's court atelier emphasized naturalism and portraiture, featuring **Ustad Mansur** (famed for flora and fauna studies) and **Bishandas** (celebrated for state portraits). Under Shah Jahan, the imperial court chronicle was illuminated as the **Padshahnama** (पादशाहनामा).
10. Deccani painting centres are **Ahmadnagar**, **Bijapur**, and **Golconda** (गोलकोंडा), often with gold ground and books such as *Nujum al-Ulum*.
11. **Rajput** painting is Rajasthan princely and bhakti / ragamala based. **Pahari** painting is Himalayan hill painting. Kangra is hills, not Rajasthan plains.
12. In Rajasthani painting, the Mewar school is highlighted by the master artist **Sahibdin**, Kishangarh is celebrated for the iconic **Bani Thani** (बनी ठनी) portrait by Nihal Chand, and Nathdwara is renowned for **Pichwai** (पिछवाई) cloth paintings dedicated to Shrinathji. Bundi and Kotah are famed for dynamic hunting landscapes.
13. Pahari sequence runs **Basohli → Guler (Nainsukh / Manaku) → Kangra (Sansar Chand)**. Basohli is bold and flat; Kangra is lyrical Krishna–nature.
14. **Garhwal** is a Pahari school. **Mola Ram** (मोला राम) is its named master. The line begins with **Shyamdas** and **Hardas** as *Tasbirdar* at Srinagar Garhwal in **1658**.
15. Other Pahari place-names to keep distinct are **Chamba**, **Nurpur**, and **Bilaspur** beside the Basohli–Guler–Kangra spine.
16. **Tanjore** painting uses gold foil and gems on wood. **Mysore** painting uses finer gesso and is less gem-studded.
17. **Srikalahasti Kalamkari** is temple pen-work. **Machilipatnam Kalamkari** is block-printed trade cloth.
18. Traditional Indian folk painting traditions include **Madhubani** of Bihar, **Warli** of Maharashtra, **Phad** of Rajasthan, **Pattachitra** (पट्टचित्र) of Odisha and Bengal, **Gond** of Madhya Pradesh, **Pithora** of Gujarat/MP, **Kalighat** (कालीघाट) of West Bengal, and the stencilled **Sanjhi** (सांझी) art of the Braj region in Uttar Pradesh.
19. **Cheriyal** is Telangana narrative scroll painting. **Manjusha** is Bihar's snake-theme scroll art of the Bhagalpur belt. **Tikuli** is glass-and-enamel craft painting linked with Bihar.
20. Tibetan–Himalayan **Thangka** painting is scroll art of Buddhist deities and mandalas. It is not a Rajasthani miniature school.
21. **Madhubani** has a GI tag. It is **not** UNESCO intangible heritage. Do not confuse GI with ICH.

22. **Ravi Varma** used oil and oleograph realism. **Abanindranath** led the Bengal School wash revival and painted **Bharat Mata** (भारत माता).
23. **Nandalal Bose** painted the Haripura Congress panels and Constitution illumination. The **Progressive Artists' Group** formed in **1947. Amrita Sher-Gil** painted *Three Girls*.
24. The **Company School** made colonial documentary pictures for East India Company patrons. It is not the nationalist Bengal School.
25. Awadh and Lucknow painting is distinguished by the master artist **Mihr Chand** and local Company School developments. In Varanasi, **Bharat Kala Bhavan** at Banaras Hindu University houses one of India's richest collections of Mughal and Rajasthani miniatures.
26. Ajanta technique is pigment on **wet** plaster (fresco tradition). Tempera / secco puts binder on a **dry** surface.
27. A **mural** is wall or ceiling paint integral to a building. A **miniature** is a small album or manuscript picture.
28. Basohli is epitomized by *Rasamanjari* cycles with hot flat colour. Kangra softens into green–blue–pink Krishna lyricism under **Sansar Chand**.
29. **Marwar**, **Bikaner**, and **Jaipur** are additional Rajasthani ateliers beside Mewar, Kishangarh, Bundi, and Kotah.
30. **Pithora** of the Rathwa (Gujarat / western Madhya Pradesh) is ritual wall painting, not a Mughal album style.
31. **Gond** painting of Madhya Pradesh uses dotted tree-and-animal patterning. Do not place Gond in Bihar or Maharashtra.
32. The celebrated treatise *Venushilpa* by Chitracharya Upendra Maharathi is a definitive work on **bamboo** art and craft, not a painting school.

📋 Must-score facts — murals, Mughal, Rajput/Pahari

Prehistoric / mural

Site	Correct
Bhimbetka	Raisen, **MP**; Wakankar **1957–58**
Jogimara	Ramgarh, **Chhattisgarh**; earliest surviving fresco site
UP rock-art belt	**Mirzapur–Sonbhadra** (Bagh = MP, not UP)
Ajanta vs Ellora	**Paintings** vs **sculpture** (Kailasa)
Ajanta Cave 1 / 16 / 17	Padmapani–Vajrapani / Dying Princess / Vessantara themes

Shadanga (six limbs)

Rupabheda · Pramanam · Bhava · Lavanyam · Sadrisyam · Varnikabhanga

Court / school tags

School	Correct
Akbar atelier	Hamzanama, Tuti-nama, Razmnama; Daswanth, Basawan
Jahangir	**Ustad Mansur** (birds/flowers); Bishandas (portraits)
Deccani	Ahmadnagar, Bijapur, Golconda
Rajput vs Pahari	Rajasthan princely / ragamala vs Himalayan hills
Mewar / Kishangarh / Nathdwara	Sahibdin / **Bani Thani** / Pichwai

Topic 5 — Indian Music

Consolidated — 34 Must-Score Facts

1. In Indian tradition, **Sangeet** encompasses the triad of **gita** (vocal music), **vadya** (instrumental music), and **nritya** (नृत्य) (dance). The earliest textual foundation for sacred melodic chanting is the **Samaveda** (सामवेद).
2. Theory roots are **Natyashastra** (नाट्यशास्त्र) by **Bharata Muni** (भरत मुनि) and the first clear use of the word **raga** in **Matanga**'s *Brihaddeshi* (बृहद्देशी).
3. The medieval encyclopedia is **Sangeet Ratnakar** (संगीत रत्नाकर) by **Sharngadeva** (शार्ङ्गदेव) (**13th** century, Devagiri).
4. There are **seven** swaras (**Sa Re Ga Ma Pa Dha Ni**) and traditionally **22** shrutis in an octave.
5. **Hindustani** (हिंदुस्तानी) is the north Indian system of khayal / dhrupad, tabla / pakhawaj, and gharanas. **Carnatic** (कर्नाटक) is the south Indian system of kriti, **72** melakarta, and mridangam.
6. **Dhrupad** (ध्रुपद) is the oldest surviving classical form and uses **pakhawaj. Khayal** is dominant today and uses **tabla**.
7. **Thumri** (ठुमरी) is light romantic song of the Awadh–Banaras belt. **Tappa** (टप्पा) has camel-song origin and is linked with **Muhammad Shah**'s court, not Akbar.
8. **Tarana** (तराना) uses nonsense syllables. **Qawwali** is linked with **Amir Khusrau** (अमीर खुसरो) at Nizamuddin's circle.
9. The Carnatic Trinity is **Tyagaraja** (Telugu Rama kritis), **Muthuswami Dikshitar** (मुत्तुस्वामी दीक्षितर्) (Sanskrit), and **Syama Sastri** (श्याम शास्त्री) (Devi kritis). They are not Tansen's line.
10. Treatise matches are **Ragamala–Pundrik Vitthal**, **Rasa Kaumudi–Sri Kantha**, **Raga Vibodh–Somanath**, and **Chaturdandi Prakashika–Venkatamakhin**.
11. **Gwalior** is the oldest khayal gharana. **Agra** (आगरा) gharana is of Agra city in UP. **Kirana** gharana is of Kirana village in the western UP belt.
12. **Rampur–Sahaswan** is an Uttar Pradesh gharana of refined taans; **Ustad Rashid Khan** belongs to this line.
13. Celebrated gharana maestros include **Ustad Bade Ghulam Ali Khan** of the **Patiala** Gharana, **Kishori Amonkar** of the **Jaipur–Atrauli** Gharana, and **Ustad Allauddin Khan** of the **Maihar** Gharana (located in **Madhya Pradesh**, not Uttar Pradesh).
14. **Mewati** gharana is bhajan-coloured khayal; **Pandit Jasraj** is its flagship name. **Bhendi Bazar** is a Mumbai gharana known for note-stretching.
15. **Dagar** bani leads the modern dhrupad revival. Early dhrupad patronage is linked with **Man Singh Tomar** of Gwalior. **Senia** is the **Tansen** instrumental line.
16. **Kirana** is strongly linked with **Bhimsen Joshi**. Do not place Maihar or Tyagaraja Aradhana inside UP.
17. Instrument families are **tata** (तत्) (plucked string), **vitat** (bowed string), **sushira** (wind), **avanaddha** (अवनद्ध) (membrane), and **ghana** (घन) (solid / idiophone).
18. **Sitar** and **sarod** are Tata instruments. **Imdadkhani / Etawah** is a major sitar gharana. **Maihar** disciples include **Ravi Shankar**, **Ali Akbar Khan**, and **Annapurna Devi**.
19. **Sarangi** is the classic bowed accompaniment of Hindustani vocal music. **Saraswati veena** and **rudra veena / been** are classical string pillars; rudra veena pairs with dhrupad.
20. **Tabla** pairs with khayal and thumri. **Pakhawaj** pairs with dhrupad. **Mridangam** (मृदंगम्) is the Carnatic primary drum.
21. **Shehnai** is the Hindustani reed of Banaras. **Nadaswaram** (नादस्वरम्) is the Carnatic temple reed. **Bansuri** (flute) is a sushira solo voice of Hindustani music.
22. **Tansen** (तानसेन) was a dhrupad master of Akbar's Navaratna, earlier at the court of Raja Ramchandra of Bhata / Rewa. He is not part of the Carnatic Trinity.

23. Renowned musical legends associated with Uttar Pradesh include **Ustad Bismillah Khan** (shehnai, Varanasi), **Begum Akhtar** (Ghazal and Thumri, Faizabad and Lucknow), and **Girija Devi** (the "Queen of Thumri", Banaras).
24. Key light-classical traditions of Uttar Pradesh include **Thumri** (nurtured in Lucknow and Banaras), **Kajri** (कजरी) (monsoon songs rooted in Mirzapur and Varanasi), and the Dhrupad legacy of **Swami Haridas** at Vrindavan.
25. **Sangeet Natak Akademi** was founded in **1952** at New Delhi as the apex body for music, dance, and theatre.
26. The chronological conferment of the **Bharat Ratna** upon classical musicians is: **M.S. Subbulakshmi (1998)**, **Pt. Ravi Shankar (1999)**, **Ustad Bismillah Khan (2001)**, and **Pt. Bhimsen Joshi (2008)**.
27. A **raga** is a melody framework. A **tala** (ताल) is a beat-cycle. **Teental** is **16** beats. Carnatic **Adi tala** is **8**.
28. Vedic chanting is UNESCO ICH **2008**. Manipuri **Sankirtana** is UNESCO ICH **2013**.
29. The prestigious annual **Tansen Samaroh** is hosted at the tomb of Tansen in **Gwalior, Madhya Pradesh**, not in Uttar Pradesh.
30. **Harmonium** is a free-reed keyboard used widely in Hindustani accompaniment; it is not a classical Tata string.
31. Carnatic composition forms centre on the **kriti**. Hindustani improvisation centres on **alap–jor–jhala** (instrumental) and **vilambit–drut** khayal.
32. **Indore** and **Delhi** appear as historic gharana place-names beside Gwalior, Agra, and Patiala; learn them as Hindustani houses, not Carnatic schools.
33. **Banaras** is a major tabla and thumri centre (Kishan Maharaj, Girija Devi). Do not collapse Banaras into only shehnai.
34. Gharana is a **Hindustani** guru–shishya house. Carnatic lines run by composer and kriti, not by gharana.

📋 Must-score facts — forms, treatises, gharanas

Frame

Item	Correct
Sangeet	Gita + vadya + nritya
Earliest chant	**Samaveda**
Natyashastra	**Bharata Muni**
First clear "raga"	Matanga *Brihaddeshi*
Sangeet Ratnakar	**Sharngadeva**, 13th c., Devagiri
Swaras / shrutis	**7** / traditionally **22**

Forms / systems

Form	Correct
Hindustani vs Carnatic	North khayal–dhrupad vs South kriti–melakarta
Dhrupad	Oldest; **pakhawaj**
Khayal	Dominant today; **tabla**
Thumri	Awadh–Banaras romantic
Tappa	Camel-song origin; **Muhammad Shah** court
Qawwali / Tarana	Khusrau–Nizamuddin / nonsense syllables
Carnatic Trinity	Tyagaraja, Dikshitar, Syama Sastri

Treatise / gharana

Item	Correct
Ragamala / Rasa Kaumudi / Raga Vibodh / Chaturdandi	Pundrik Vitthal / Sri Kantha / **Somanath** / Venkatamakhin

Item	Correct
Oldest khayal gharana	**Gwalior**
Agra / Kirana	Agra city UP / Kirana village
Patiala / Jaipur–Atrauli / Maihar	Bade Ghulam Ali / Kishori Amonkar / Allauddin Khan

Topic 6 — Indian Dance

Consolidated Must-Score Facts

1. The **Sangeet Natak Akademi** recognises **eight** classical dances. **Sattriya** (सत्रीय) of Assam was added in **2000**. A list of seven has dropped Sattriya.
2. **Chhau** (छऊ) is not one of those eight. It is UNESCO martial-folk. Some notes call it a ninth style. That is not the Akademi list.
3. **Bharatanatyam** (भरतनाट्यम्) belongs to Tamil Nadu.
4. **Kathak** (कथक) belongs to North India, with Lucknow in Uttar Pradesh as the main gharana.
5. **Kathakali** (कथकली) and **Mohiniyattam** (मोहिनीअट्टम्) both belong to Kerala.
6. **Kuchipudi** (कुचिपुड़ी) belongs to Andhra Pradesh.
7. **Odissi** (ओडिसी) belongs to Odisha.
8. **Manipuri** (मणिपुरी) belongs to Manipur.
9. **Sattriya** (सत्रिया) belongs to Assam.
10. The root text is the **Natyashastra** (नाट्यशास्त्र) of **Bharata Muni** (भरत मुनि). It teaches **nine** rasas.
11. The four abhinaya are **angika** (आंगिक) (body), **vachika** (speech or song), **aharya** (costume), and **sattvika** (सात्त्विक) (inner feeling).
12. **Nritta** (नृत्त) is pure dance without a story. **Nritya** (नृत्य) adds expressive abhinaya. **Natya** (नाट्य) is dance-drama.
13. **Lasya** is graceful movement. **Tandava** (तांडव) is vigorous movement. Kerala's pair is male Kathakali tandava versus female Mohiniyattam lasya.
14. **Bharatanatyam** uses the **araimandi** (अरैमंडी) half-sit. It grew from temple **sadir**. **Rukmini Devi Arundale** and Kalakshetra led the modern stage revival.
15. **Kathak** is the only one of the eight that uses Hindustani music. Markers are **chakkar** (चक्कर) spins and **tatkar** (तत्कार) footwork.
16. Kathak gharanas are **Lucknow** (लखनऊ), **Jaipur**, and **Banaras**. Lucknow is grace and abhinaya under Wajid Ali Shah and Birju Maharaj.
17. **Kathakali** uses heavy **chutti** (चुट्टी) makeup. **Pacha** (पचा) green marks the noble hero. It is not north Indian Kathak.
18. **Kuchipudi** is Andhra village dance-drama. **Tarangam** (तरंगम्) is dancing on a brass plate.
19. **Mohiniyattam** is a Kerala female solo in white-and-gold kasavu. It uses Carnatic music.
20. **Odissi** uses the **tribhanga** (त्रिभंग) three-bend posture. Temple **mahari** women and boy **gotipua** (गोटिपुआ) dancers feed the tradition.
21. **Manipuri** classical dance centres on **Ras Lila** of Manipur. Braj **Raslila** (रासलीला) of Uttar Pradesh is a separate folk Krishna play.
22. **Sattriya** grew in Assam's **satra** monasteries from **Sankaradeva** (शंकरदेव). It is the latest of the official eight.
23. Among the eight, Bharatanatyam, Kuchipudi, and Mohiniyattam use Carnatic music. Only Kathak uses Hindustani music.
24. **Garba** (गरबा) of Gujarat entered UNESCO ICH in **2023**. It is still folk, not classical.
25. **Kalbelia** of Rajasthan entered UNESCO ICH in **2010**.
26. **Chhau** entered UNESCO ICH in **2010**. It is still not on the Akademi list of eight.
27. **Bhangra** (भांगड़ा) of Punjab, **Lavani** (लावणी) of Maharashtra, and **Bihu** (बिहू) of Assam are folk. They are not among the eight.
28. **Braj Raslila** is Uttar Pradesh folk. **Charkula** (चरकुला) is a Braj lamp-wheel dance. **Mayur** is the Braj peacock dance.
29. **Chholiya** (छोलिया) is a Kumaon sword dance. **Tharu** dance belongs to the Terai.
30. Do not confuse **Kathak** the dance with **Kathaka**, a reciter name linked in some texts with the Shukla Yajurveda.
31. **Rukmini Devi Arundale** revived Bharatanatyam at Kalakshetra.

32. **Kelucharan Mohapatra** reconstructed concert Odissi.
33. **Birju Maharaj** is the Lucknow Kathak name.
34. **Vallathol Narayana Menon** is linked with Kerala Kalamandalam, Kathakali, and Mohiniyattam.
35. **Yamini Krishnamurthy** danced Bharatanatyam and Kuchipudi. She died on **3 August 2024**.
36. The *Abhinaya Darpana* of **Nandikesvara** is the hasta-mudra companion beside the Natyashastra.
37. **Sankirtana** of Manipur is UNESCO ICH **2013**. It is ritual music and dance, not a ninth Akademi classical form.

📋 Must-score drill — eight classical dances, gharanas, markers

Dance	State and marker
Bharatanatyam	Tamil Nadu; araimandi stance; sadir origin; Rukmini Devi revival
Kathak	North India / **Uttar Pradesh** (उत्तर प्रदेश); chakkar spins; tatkar footwork
Kathakali	Kerala; chutti makeup; pacha green for the noble hero
Kuchipudi	Andhra Pradesh; **tarangam** plate dance
Odissi	Odisha; tribhanga three-bend stance
Manipuri	Manipur; Ras Lila
Mohiniyattam	Kerala; female lasya; white-and-gold kasavu
Sattriya	Assam; added by SNA in **2000**
Chhau	**Not** among the eight. UNESCO martial-folk

Item	Correct
Root text	**Natyashastra** of Bharata Muni; **nine** rasas; four abhinaya
Nritta / Nritya / Natya	Pure dance / expressive dance / dance-drama
Lasya / Tandava	Graceful / vigorous
Kathak gharanas	**Lucknow** (Wajid Ali Shah, Birju Maharaj), Jaipur, Banaras

Topic 7 — Indian Theatre & Performing Arts

Consolidated Must-Score Facts

1. **Natyashastra** (नाट्यशास्त्र) by **Bharata Muni** (भरत मुनि) (about **200 BCE–200 CE**) codifies drama with about **10** rupaka (रूपक), **9** rasa (रस), and four abhinaya (अभिनय).
2. **Abhinavabharati** (अभिनवभारती) is Abhinavagupta's (अभिनवगुप्त) commentary on Natyashastra. **Dasharupaka** (दशरूपक) is Dhananjaya's (धनंजय) later summary of play types.
3. **Ashvaghosha** (अश्वघोष) is often tagged with the earliest Sanskrit play tradition. **Bhasa** (भास) left about **13** plays. **Kalidasa** (कालिदास) wrote **three** dramas.
4. **Shudraka** (शूद्रक) wrote *Mrichchhakatika* (मृच्छकटिकम्). **Vishakhadatta** (विशाखदत्त) wrote *Mudrarakshasa* (मुद्राराक्षस). **Bhavabhuti** (भवभूति) wrote *Uttararamacharita* (उत्तररामचरित). King **Harsha** (हर्ष) wrote *Ratnavali* (रत्नावली).
5. *Shringara Shataka* (शृंगार शतक) is by **Bhartrihari** (भर्तृहरि), not Kalidasa. Do not park poem titles inside the drama list.
6. **Yavanika** (यवनिका) is the stage curtain. **Nepathya** (नेपथ्य) is the backstage dressing room. **Sutradhara** (सूत्रधार) is the director and narrator-presenter.
7. The oldest rock-cut theatre in India is **Sitabenga** (सीताबेंगा) at Ramgarh in Chhattisgarh. Neighbouring **Jogimara** (जोगीमारा) is noted for early frescoes, not theatrical architecture.
8. Kerala temple theatre houses are called **koothambalam** (कूथम्बलम). Living Sanskrit theatre is **Koodiyattam** (कूड़ियाट्टम्) of the Chakyar (चाक्यार) tradition with the **mizhavu** (मिझावु) drum.
9. **Koodiyattam** is UNESCO living Sanskrit theatre (proclaimed **2001**, list **2008**). It is theatre, not a ninth SNA classical dance.
10. **Nautanki** (नौटंकी) is the high-yield **UP** folk opera, named in the *Ain-i-Akbari*, with **Kanpur** and **Lucknow** schools and the **nagara** (नगाड़ा) drum.
11. **Ramlila** (रामलीला) of Ramnagar–Varanasi / Braj is UNESCO **2008**. **Raslila** (रासलीला) is the Braj Krishna folk play, not Manipuri classical Ras Lila.
12. **Swang** (स्वांग) belongs to Haryana, western UP, and Rajasthan. **Tamasha** (तमाशा) of Maharashtra uses **Lavani** (लावणी) and often has women playing male roles.
13. **Jatra** (यात्रा) belongs to Bengal and Odisha. **Yakshagana** (यक्षगान) belongs to coastal Karnataka. **Bhavai** (भवई) belongs to Gujarat.
14. **Bhaona** (भाओना) stages **Ankiya Nat** (अंकिया नाट) in the satras of Majuli, Assam. **Ramman** (रम्माण) is the sacred masked ritual theatre of Uttarakhand. **Powada** (पोवाड़ा) belongs to Maharashtra. **Burrakatha** (बुरकथा) belongs to Andhra Pradesh.
15. **Kathputli** (कठपुतली) of Rajasthan is string marionette, often without carved legs. **Gulabo–Sitabo** (गुलाबो-सीताबो) of **Lucknow** are glove comic puppets.
16. **Kundhei** (कुंधेई) is Odisha string puppetry. **Tholu Bommalata** (तोलू बोम्मलता) of Andhra Pradesh and **Ravana Chhaya** (रावण छाया) of Odisha are shadow forms.
17. The musical drama **Indra Sabha** (इंद्र सभा), composed by **Agha Hasan Amanat** (आगा हसन अमानत) and staged at **Lucknow in 1853** under Wajid Ali Shah, marks the dawn of modern operatic theatre in Awadh.
18. **Bidesiya** (बिदेसिया) is a migration-themed folk play of the Bhojpuri belt of eastern Uttar Pradesh and western Bihar. In Banaras, **Bhartendu Harishchandra** (भारतेन्दु हरिश्चंद्र) laid the foundation of modern Hindi drama.
19. The Indian People's Theatre Association (**IPTA**) was established in **1943**. The **National School of Drama (NSD)** was founded at New Delhi in **1959**, and was shaped decisively under the legendary directorship of **Ebrahim Alkazi**.
20. **Sangeet Natak Akademi** (संगीत नाटक अकादेमी) (**1952**) covers music, dance, **and theatre**. It is not a dance-only body.

21. Sanskrit plays as a rule **end well**. Stock figures are **nayaka** (नायक), **nayika** (नायिका), and **vidushaka** (विदूषक). There is no Greek-style tragedy as the default form.
22. **Nataka** (नाटक) is a mythic heroic play type. **Prakarana** (प्रकरण) invents a social plot. Do not confuse **natya** (नाट्य, drama) with **nritta** (नृत्त, pure dance).
23. UNESCO Intangible Cultural Heritage performing arts elements include **Koodiyattam** Sanskrit theatre (**2008**), the traditional **Ramlila** (**2008**), and **Mudiyettu** (मुडियेट्टु) ritual drama (**2010**).
24. These are **not** UP: Kathputli (Rajasthan), Yakshagana (Karnataka), Koodiyattam (Kerala), Tamasha (Maharashtra), and Ramman (Uttarakhand).

📋 Must-score facts — Sanskrit drama, folk theatre, puppets

Texts / playwrights

Item	Correct
Natyashastra	Bharata; ~10 rupaka; 9 rasa
Abhinavabharati / Dasharupaka	Abhinavagupta / Dhananjaya
Bhasa (भास) / Kalidasa (कालिदास)	~13 plays / *Abhijnanashakuntalam* (अभिज्ञानशाकुन्तलम्) trio
Shudraka (शूद्रक) / Vishakhadatta (विशाखदत्त) / Bhavabhuti (भवभूति)	*Mrichchhakatika* (मृच्छकटिकम्) / *Mudrarakshasa* (मुद्राराक्षस) / *Uttararamacharita* (उत्तररामचरित)
Bhartrihari (भर्तृहरि)	*Shringara Shataka* (शृंगार शतक) (≠ Kalidasa)
Stage vocab	Yavanika = curtain; nepathya = backstage; sutradhara = presenter

Folk / UNESCO / UP

Form	Correct
Koodiyattam	Kerala living Sanskrit; UNESCO **2001/2008**
Nautanki	**UP** folk opera; Kanpur–Lucknow; *Ain-i-Akbari*
Ramlila	Ramnagar–Varanasi / Braj; UNESCO **2008**
Raslila	Braj Krishna folk (≠ Manipuri classical)
Gulabo–Sitabo	**Lucknow** glove puppets
Indra Sabha	Amanat, **Lucknow 1853**
Bidesiya / Bhartendu	E. UP–Bhojpuri / Banaras modern Hindi
IPTA / NSD	**1943** / **1959** Delhi
Not UP	Kathputli (RJ), Yakshagana (KA), Tamasha (MH), Ramman (UK)

Topic 8 — Indian Languages & Literature

Consolidated Must-Score Facts

1. **Shruti** (श्रुति) is the heard Veda stack of Samhita (संहिता), Brahmana (ब्राह्मण), Aranyaka (आरण्यक), and Upanishad (उपनिषद्). **Smriti** (स्मृति) covers epics, Puranas, Dharmashastra, and related remembered texts.
2. The four Vedas are **Rig** (ऋग्वेद, hymns), **Sama** (सामवेद, chant), **Yajur** (यजुर्वेद, ritual), and **Atharva** (अथर्ववेद). Shukla Yajurveda is **Vajasaneyi** (वाजसनेयी). Krishna Yajurveda is **Taittiriya** (तैत्तिरीय).
3. **Valmiki**'s (वाल्मीकि) *Ramayana* (रामायण) has **seven** kandas. **Vyasa**'s (व्यास) *Mahabharata* (महाभारत) has **eighteen** parvas. The *Bhagavad Gita* (भगवद्गीता) sits inside **Bhishma Parva** (भीष्म पर्व).
4. **Kalidasa** (कालिदास) wrote *Meghaduta* (मेघदूत), *Raghuvamsha* (रघुवंश), *Kumarasambhava* (कुमारसंभव), and *Ritusamhara* (ऋतुसंहार). His three dramas are *Abhijnanashakuntalam* (अभिज्ञानशाकुन्तलम्), *Vikramorvashiya* (विक्रमोर्वशीयम्), and *Malavikagnimitram* (मालविकाग्निमित्रम्).
5. *Mudrarakshasa* (मुद्राराक्षस) by **Vishakhadatta** (विशाखदत्त) is a historical political drama about Chandragupta Maurya and Chanakya. It has no major romantic theme.
6. **Trivikrama Bhatta** (त्रिविक्रम भट्ट) wrote *Nalachampu* (नलचम्पू). **Somadeva** (सोमदेव) wrote *Kathasaritsagara* (कथासरित्सागर). **Jayadeva** (जयदेव) wrote *Gita Govinda* (गीत गोविंद). **Kshemendra** (क्षेमेन्द्र) wrote *Brihatkathamanjari* (बृहत्कथामंजरी).
7. Early Tamil literature is the **Sangam** (संगम) corpus. *Ettuttokai* (एट्टुत्तोकै) is the Eight Anthologies. *Pattuppattu* (पत्तुप्पाट्टु) is the Ten Idylls. *Tolkappiyam* (तोल्काप्पियम्) is grammar. The later epics are *Silappadikaram* (शिलप्पदिकारम्) and *Manimekalai* (मणिमेकलै).
8. **Charaka** (चरक) wrote the *Charaka Samhita* (चरक संहिता). **Sushruta** (सुश्रुत) wrote the *Sushruta Samhita* (सुश्रुत संहिता). **Aryabhata** (आर्यभट) wrote the *Aryabhatiya* (आर्यभटीय). **Varahamihira** (वराहमिहिर) wrote the *Brihatsamhita* (बृहत्संहिता).
9. The oldest Buddhist canon is the Pali **Tipitaka** (तिपिटक): Vinaya, Sutta, and Abhidhamma. The Jain canon is Prakrit **Angas** (अंग) and Upangas.
10. **Ashvaghosha** (अश्वघोष) wrote *Buddhacharita* (बुद्धचरित) and *Saundarananda* (सौंदरानंद). **Bhasa** (भास) left about **13** plays. King **Harsha** (हर्ष) wrote *Ratnavali* (रत्नावली), *Nagananda* (नागानन्द), and *Priyadarshika* (प्रियदर्शिका).
11. **Amir Khusrau** (अमीर खुसरो) wrote in Persian and early Hindavi. He served under multiple Delhi Sultanate rulers and coined the phrase about the Indian parrot (*Tuti-i-Hind*).
12. **Basaveshwara** (बसवेश्वर) wrote Kannada vachanas. **Jnaneshwar** (ज्ञानेश्वर) wrote the Marathi *Jnaneshwari* (ज्ञानेश्वरी). **Alvars** (आलवार) composed the *Nalayira Divya Prabandham* (नालायिर दिव्य प्रबंधम्).
13. *Rajatarangini* (राजतरंगिणी) by **Kalhana** (कल्हण), twelfth century Sanskrit, is the first formal historical chronicle of Kashmir.
14. In **October 2024**, the Union Cabinet approved **five new Classical Languages**: **Marathi**, **Pali**, **Prakrit**, **Assamese**, and **Bengali**.
15. The chronology of previously declared Classical Languages is: Tamil (**2004**), Sanskrit (**2005**), Telugu and Kannada (**2008**), Malayalam (**2013**), and Odia (**2014**), bringing the total count to **11 Classical Languages**.
16. **Tulsidas** (तुलसीदास) wrote the Awadhi *Ramcharitmanas* (रामचरितमानस). **Surdas** (सूरदास) wrote Braj *Sursagar* (सूरसागर). **Malik Muhammad Jayasi** (मलिक मुहम्मद जायसी) wrote the Awadhi *Padmavat* (पद्मावत).
17. **Bhartendu Harishchandra** (भारतेन्दु हरिश्चंद्र) of Banaras is the father of modern Hindi dramatic and prose literature.
18. The renowned Sanskrit scholar **Kavindra Acharya Saraswati** of Banaras was patronized by Emperor **Shah Jahan** (शाहजहाँ); he famously persuaded the emperor to abolish the pilgrimage tax on Hindu pilgrims at Kashi and Prayag.
19. The Eighth Schedule of the Constitution lists **22** languages. It began with 14; Sindhi was added in 1967 (21st Amendment); Konkani, Manipuri, and Nepali in 1992 (71st Amendment); and Bodo, Dogri, Maithili, and Santhali in 2003 (92nd Amendment).

20. English and Rajasthani are **not** in the Eighth Schedule. Bhojpuri is also **not** currently listed.
21. The criteria for Classical Language status require **1500–2000 years** of high antiquity, an original literary tradition, and distinctiveness from modern vernacular offshoots.
22. *Harshacharita* (हर्षचरित) and *Kadambari* (कादंबरी) were composed by **Banabhatta** (बाणभट्ट), court poet of King Harsha.
23. *Gita Govinda* (गीत गोविंद) was composed by **Jayadeva** (जयदेव) in twelfth-century Odisha/Bengal.
24. Maharishi Valmiki is revered as the *Adikavi* for composing the original Sanskrit *Ramayana*, while Goswami Tulsidas composed the celebrated 16th-century Awadhi retelling, the *Ramcharitmanas*.
25. *Tolkappiyam* (तोल्काप्पियम्) is grammar. *Tirukkural* (तिरुक्कुरल) is by **Tiruvalluvar** (तिरुवल्लुवर). *Silappadikaram* (शिलप्पदिकारम्) is by **Ilango Adigal** (इलंगो अडिगल). *Manimekalai* (मणिमेकलै) is by **Sattanar** (सत्तनार).
26. **Kamban** (कंबन) wrote *Ramavataram* (रामावतारम्), the Tamil Ramayana. ***Tirumurai*** (तिरुमुरै) is the Saiva hymn corpus treated as a Fifth Veda of Tamil Shaivism.
27. **Alvars** number **12** (Vaishnava); **Nayanars** (नायनार) number **63** (Shaiva). Do not reverse the counts.
28. Greek **Herodotus** is the **Father of History**; his *Histories / Historica* describes Indo–Persian relations in the **5th century BCE**. *Natural History* is **Pliny the Elder**, not Ptolemy.
29. Gupta-age classics include **Amarasimha**'s (अमरसिंह) *Amarakosha* (अमरकोश), **Vatsyayana**'s (वात्स्यायन) *Kamasutra* (कामसूत्र), **Kalidasa**'s (कालिदास) *Meghaduta* (मेघदूत), and **Vishakhadatta**'s (विशाखदत्त) *Mudrarakshasa* (मुद्राराक्षस) (Maurya overthrow of the Nandas, written in the Gupta age).
30. **Panini** (पाणिनि) wrote the *Ashtadhyayi* (अष्टाध्यायी). **Patanjali** (पतंजलि) wrote the *Mahabhashya* (महाभाष्य). **Yaska** (यास्क) wrote the *Nirukta* (निरुक्त). **Katyayana** (कात्यायन) wrote the *Varttika* (वार्त्तिक). Panini is not a Pushyamitra court poet. Patanjali is Shunga-linked.
31. **Kalhana**'s *Rajatarangini* is the Sanskrit chronicle of **Kashmir** kings, completed under **Jayasimha / Jai Singh (1128–1149)**, in **eight** tarangas. Continuators are **Jonaraja** and **Srivara**.
32. **Harsha** (हर्ष) wrote *Ratnavali* (रत्नावली), *Priyadarshika* (प्रियदर्शिका), and *Nagananda* (नागानन्द). *Harshacharita* and *Kadambari* are **Banabhatta**. *Karpuramanjari* (कर्पूरमंजरी) is **Rajasekhara** (राजशेखर), not Harsha.
33. **Sriharsha** (श्रीहर्ष) wrote *Naishadhiyacharita* (नैषधीयचरित). **Bharavi** (भारवि) wrote *Kiratarjuniya* (किरातार्जुनीय). **Magha** (माघ) wrote *Shishupalavadha* (शिशुपालवध). *Dashakumaracharita* (दशकुमारचरित) by **Dandin** (दंडी) is not a Mahabharata theme.
34. **Varahamihira** (वराहमिहिर) wrote *Panchasiddhantika* (पंचसिद्धांतिका) (based on **Greek** astronomy), *Brihatsamhita* (बृहत्संहिता) (encyclopedic), and *Brihat Jataka* (बृहज्जातक). *Amarakosha* (अमरकोश) is **Amarasimha** (अमरसिंह), not Varaha.
35. **Charaka Samhita** (चरक संहिता) is Ayurveda medicine in **120 chapters** and **eight** sections. **Bhaskara II**'s (भास्कर द्वितीय) *Siddhantashiromani* (सिद्धांत शिरोमणि) has four parts: *Lilavati* (लीलावती), *Bijaganita* (बीजगणित), *Ganitadhyaya* (गणिताध्याय), *Goladhyaya* (गोलाध्याय) (algebra fame).
36. **Aryabhata** (आर्यभट) wrote *Aryabhatiya* (आर्यभटीय); earth is spherical and rotates; often tagged for trigonometry and decimal place-value teaching. **Zero** as a numeral is credited to an **anonymous Indian** (Arabs used it by **873 CE**).
37. *Panchatantra* (पंचतंत्र) is attributed to **Vishnu Sharma** (विष्णु शर्मा). Abul Fazl's Mughal Persian rendering is ***Ayar-e-Danish*** (आयारे दानिश).
38. *Natyashastra* (नाट्यशास्त्र) is **Bharata Muni** (भरत मुनि). **Bhasa** (भास) wrote *Svapnavasavadattam* (स्वप्नवासवदत्तम्) and *Madhyama-vyayoga* (मध्यमव्यायोग).
39. **Manusmriti** (मनुस्मृति) is mainly the social and law system. **Mitakshara** (मिताक्षरा) is **Vijnaneshwara** (विज्ञानेश्वर) on Yajnavalkya. **Dayabhaga** (दायाभाग) is **Jimutavahana** (जीमूतवाहन).
40. Court–poet matches: **Chandragupta II** (चंद्रगुप्त द्वितीय)–**Kalidasa** (कालिदास); **Samudragupta** (समुद्रगुप्त)–**Harisena** (हरिषेण); **Harsha** (हर्ष)–**Banabhatta** (बाणभट्ट); **Alauddin Khalji** (अलाउद्दीन खिलजी)–**Amir Khusrau** (अमीर खुसरो). **Jayadeva** (जयदेव) (*Gita Govinda* (गीत गोविंद)) adorned **Lakshmana Sena**'s Bengal court.
41. Wrong-pair traps: *Devichandraguptam* (देवीचन्द्रगुप्तम्) = **Vishakhadatta** (विशाखदत्त) (not **Bilhana** (बिल्हण)); *Milindapanha* (मिलिंदपन्ह) monk = **Nagasena** (नागसेन) (not Nagarjuna); *Kadambari* (कादंबरी) = **Banabhatta**

(बाणभट्ट) (not Subandhu); *Buddhacharita* (बुद्धचरित) = **Ashvaghosha** (अश्वघोष) (not Vasubandhu).

42. *Mattavilasa Prahasana* (मत्तविलास प्रहसन) is Pallava **Mahendravarman I** (महेन्द्रवर्मन प्रथम). *Gaudavaho* (गौडवहो) is **Vakpati** (वाकपति). *Katantra* (कातंत्र) is **Sarvavarman** (सर्ववर्मन). *Nitisara* (नीतिसार) is **Kamandaka** (कामंदक).

📋 Must-score facts — Vedas, authors, classical languages

Shruti / epics

Item	Correct
Shruti stack	Samhita → Brahmana → Aranyaka → Upanishad
Four Vedas	Rig · Sama · Yajur · Atharva
Ramayana / Mahabharata	Valmiki **7** kandas / Vyasa **18** parvas
Itihasa vs Purana	Epics vs 18 Maha Puranas

Author ↔ work (high-yield)

Author	Work
Kalidasa (कालिदास)	*Abhijnanashakuntalam* (अभिज्ञानशाकुन्तलम्), *Malavikagnimitram* (मालविकाग्निमित्रम्), *Vikramorvashiya* (विक्रमोर्वशीयम्); *Raghuvamsha* (रघुवंश), *Kumarasambhava* (कुमारसंभव), *Meghaduta* (मेघदूत), *Ritusamhara* (ऋतुसंहार)
Bhartrihari (भर्तृहरि)	*Shringara Shataka* (शृंगार शतक)
Panini / Patanjali	*Ashtadhyayi* / *Mahabhashya*
Charaka / Sushruta	Medicine / surgery
Banabhatta	*Harshacharita*, *Kadambari*
Jayadeva	*Gita Govinda*
Tulsidas / Surdas	Awadhi *Ramcharitmanas* / Braj
Kabir	Maghar / Sant Kabir Nagar

Language tags

Item	Correct
8th Schedule	**22** languages; **Bhojpuri out**
Sahitya Akademi	**24** languages (22 + English + Rajasthani)
Classical languages	**11** after **3 Oct 2024**
Early classical years	Tamil 2004 · Sanskrit 2005 · Kannada/Telugu 2008 · Malayalam 2013 · Odia 2014
Alvars / Nayanars	**12** Vaishnava / **63** Shaiva
Court–poet	CG II (चंद्रगुप्त द्वितीय)–Kalidasa (कालिदास); Samudragupta (समुद्रगुप्त)–Harisena (हरिषेण); Harsha (हर्ष)–Bana (बाण)

Topic 9 — Indian Festivals & Fairs

Consolidated Must-Score Facts

1. The four **Kumbh** sites are **Prayagraj** (प्रयागराज), **Haridwar** (हरिद्वार), **Nashik**, and **Ujjain** (उज्जैन). Their rivers are Ganga–Yamuna–Saraswati, Ganga, Godavari, and Shipra. **Pushkar** is not a Kumbh site.
2. **Kumbh Mela** is on the UNESCO Intangible Heritage list from **2017. Magh Mela** is the annual bathing fair at Prayagraj; it is not the twelve-year mega Kumbh at every site.
3. Maha Kumbh at **Prayagraj** in **2025** ran from **13 January to 26 February** for about **45** days at the Sangam.
4. **Pushkar Fair** (पुष्कर मेला) is the **Rajasthan** (थार) camel and livestock fair of **Kartik** near Ajmer. **Pushkar Kumbh** of May **2025** was at **Mana / Keshav Prayag** in **Uttarakhand**, not Rajasthan and not Uttar Pradesh.
5. **Pongal** (पोंगल) is the **Tamil Nadu** January harvest festival. **Onam** (ओणम) is the **Kerala** Aug–Sep harvest linked to Mahabali. Do not swap the two states.
6. **Bihu** (बिहू) is the **Assam** harvest trio. **Hornbill** is the **Nagaland** cultural showcase at **Kisama**, usually **1–10 December**.
7. **Baisakhi** (बैसाखी) and **Lohri** belong to **Punjab** (Lohri also Haryana–Himachal). **Nuakhai** (नुआखाइ) is the **Odisha** (ओडिशा) harvest. **Vishu** (विशु) is the **Kerala** New Year, not Ugadi.
8. **Ugadi** (उगादि) is New Year in **Andhra Pradesh, Telangana, and Karnataka. Gudi Padwa** is the **Maharashtra** New Year in the same season. **Bathukamma** (बतुकम्मा) is the **Telangana** floral festival.
9. **Garba / Dandiya** is **Gujarat** Navratri dance and UNESCO ICH from **2023. Bhangra / Giddha** is **Punjab** harvest dance at Baisakhi. Garba is not a ninth SNA classical.
10. **Durga Puja of Kolkata** is UNESCO ICH from **2021. Navratri** is the nine-night goddess cycle; Gujarat's Garba sits inside Navratri, not inside Bengal pandals alone.
11. **Ramlila** (रामलीला) is the Ramayana play on UNESCO ICH from **2008. Dussehra / Vijayadashami** is the Ravana-effigy day. Ramlila is theatre, not classical dance.
12. **Sarhul** (सरहुल) is the **Jharkhand** tribal sal-flower festival. **Bastar Dussehra** in **Chhattisgarh** lasts about **75** days around Danteshwari and is not Rama–Ravana Dussehra.
13. **Medaram Jatara** (मेदारम जातरा) is the **Telangana** Koya tribal pilgrimage. **Bhagoria** (भगोरिया) is the **Madhya Pradesh** Bhil festival. **Wangala** is the **Meghalaya** Garo harvest. **Chapchar Kut** (चपचार कुट) is **Mizoram. Sangai** is **Manipur**.
14. **Surajkund** (सूरजकुंड) crafts mela is in **Haryana** in February. It is not Rajasthan and not Uttar Pradesh.
15. **Sonepur** cattle fair is in **Bihar. Gangasagar** mela is in **West Bengal. Ambubachi** is at Kamakhya in Assam.
16. Uttar Pradesh festival spine: **Prayagraj Kumbh / Magh Mela**, **Braj Holi** (Mathura–Vrindavan–Barsana), **Ramlila** (Ramnagar / Varanasi), eastern **Chhath** (छठ), **Taj Mahotsav** (Agra, February), **Ganga Mahotsav** (Varanasi), **Lucknow Mahotsav**, and **Ayodhya Deepotsav**.
17. **Chhath** is sun worship on eastern UP–Bihar–Jharkhand ghats. It is not moon worship.
18. **Deva Mela** is held at **Barabanki**, while the historic **Bateshwar Fair** takes place in **Agra** (आगरा) district. Mourning processions of Muharram represent an integral part of the Shia cultural tradition in Lucknow.
19. Government cultural festivals include **Taj Mahotsav** (Agra), **Ganga Mahotsav** (Varanasi), **Lucknow Mahotsav**, **Khajuraho Dance Festival** (Madhya Pradesh), and **Tansen Samaroh** (Gwalior, Madhya Pradesh). Tansen is not a UP fair.
20. South Indias: **Pongal** (four-day January in Tamil Nadu), **Onam** (Kerala), **Mysore Dasara** (Karnataka), **Thrissur Pooram** (त्रिशूर पूरम) (Kerala), and **Bathukamma** (Telangana).
21. Key North-Eastern festivals include: **Hornbill** (Nagaland), **Sangai** (सांगाइ) (Manipur), **Chapchar Kut** (Mizoram), **Wangala** (celebrated by the Garo of Meghalaya), and **Losar** (लोसार) (the Buddhist New Year observed across Sikkim, Arunachal Pradesh, and Ladakh).
22. **Eid-ul-Fitr** ends Ramadan. **Eid-ul-Adha** is Bakrid, the sacrifice festival. Do not treat them as one festival.

23. National days are **Republic Day (26 January)**, **Independence Day (15 August)**, and **Gandhi Jayanti (2 October)**. They sit beside harvest and religious calendars, not inside Kumbh geography.
24. Folk festivals such as **Braj Holi** are peasant / regional joy. Tribal festivals such as **Sarhul** are adivasi ritual calendars. Do not collapse folk and tribal into one label.
25. **Kullu Dussehra** is Himachal. **Ratha Yatra** of Puri is Odisha. **Ganesh Chaturthi** (गणेश चतुर्थी) is Maharashtra's flagship. **Hemis** is the Ladakh monastery festival.
26. These are **not** Uttar Pradesh festival homes: Pushkar Fair (Rajasthan), Pushkar Kumbh 2025 (Uttarakhand), Surajkund (Haryana), Onam (Kerala), Hornbill (Nagaland), and Tansen Samaroh (Gwalior).

📋 Must-score facts — Kumbh, harvest, UNESCO, UP

Kumbh / fairs

Item	Correct
Four Kumbh sites	Prayagraj, Haridwar, Nashik, Ujjain
Kumbh UNESCO ICH	**2017**
Magh Mela	Annual Prayagraj bathing (≠ full Kumbh)
Pushkar Fair	**Rajasthan** camel fair (Kartik)
Surajkund	**Haryana** crafts (≠ RJ / UP)
Sonepur / Gangasagar	Bihar / West Bengal

Festival ↔ state

Festival	State / tag
Pongal / Onam	Tamil Nadu / Kerala (do not swap)
Bihu / Hornbill	Assam / Nagaland (Kisama)
Ugadi / Gudi Padwa	AP–TS–KA / Maharashtra New Year
Garba	Gujarat; UNESCO **2023**
Durga Puja (Kolkata)	UNESCO **2021**
Ramlila	UNESCO **2008**; Dussehra = effigy day
Sarhul / Bastar Dussehra	Jharkhand / Chhattisgarh (~75 days)

UP spine

Prayagraj Kumbh/Magh · Braj Holi · Ramlila · Chhath · Deva Mela (Barabanki) · Bateshwar (Agra)

Not UP: Pushkar, Surajkund, Onam, Hornbill, Kullu Dussehra.

Topic 10 — Ancient Indian History Related to Culture

Consolidated Must-Score Facts

1. Ancient Indian cultural span runs from **Bhimbetka** (भीमबेटका) rock art through **Indus Valley** cities (about **2600–1900 BCE**), then **Maurya** (मौर्य), **Shunga–Kushan**, and **Gupta** (गुप्त) (4th–6th century CE).
2. Hallmark artistic achievements of the Indus Valley Civilisation include carved **steatite seals**, figurines of the **terracotta Mother Goddess**, meticulously planned baked-brick cities, and the iconic **Dancing Girl** bronze sculpture cast using the **lost-wax** (*cire perdue* (सिर पर्ड्यू)) technique.
3. **Northern Black Polished Ware (NBPW)** is the diagnostic deluxe pottery of the Mauryan and Northern Black Polished Ware period, while the classical Buddhist rock-cut murals of **Ajanta** (अजंता) represent the zenith of **Gupta–Vakataka** painting.
4. Sculpture schools: **Gandhara uses grey** schist **with Greco-Roman Buddha style in the north-west.** Mathura **(मथुरा) uses red** sandstone **and is indigenous in** Uttar Pradesh. Amaravati **uses white** limestone** narrative panels in Andhra.
5. **Mauryan polish** (मौर्य) on **Chunar** (चुनार) sandstone (Mirzapur belt) gives a mirror finish. The **Didarganj Yakshi** (दीदारगंज यक्षी) is the classic Mauryan polish figure.
6. **Bharhut** (भरहुत) and early **Sanchi** (सांची) are **Shunga** narrative reliefs. Early Sanchi is largely **aniconic** (अप्रतिमेय) (wheel, tree, throne), not a human Buddha.
7. The **Gupta Sarnath Buddha** shows the **dharmachakra** (धर्मचक्र) mudra, a transparent robe, and calm idealism. It is the peak of classical Buddhist sculpture.
8. Architecture spine: Indus **grid and drains**, **Great Bath** at Mohenjo-daro, **Lothal dock**, Mauryan **Barabar** (बराबर) rock-cut caves, and Gupta **first structural temples** such as **Deogarh** and **Bhitargaon** (भीतरगाँव).
9. A **stupa** is a solid relic mound. A **chaitya** (चैत्य) is a rock-cut prayer hall with an apse stupa. Do not swap the two.
10. **Rock-cut** architecture (Barabar, chaityas) is carved into living rock. **Structural** temples are built from the Gupta age onward as freestanding buildings.
11. Uttar Pradesh Indus sites are **Alamgirpur** (आलमगीरपुर), **Mandi**, and **Hulas. Alamgirpur** (Meerut belt) is the **easternmost** Indus site.
12. **Rakhigarhi** is in **Haryana** and is the largest Indus site in India. It is **not** in Uttar Pradesh.
13. **Sanauli** (सनौली) (Baghpat district, UP) is a late Harappan / Ochre Coloured Pottery (OCP) burial site famous for the discovery of copper-plated **war chariots**, coffins, and weaponry, representing a distinct post-urban transitional phase.
14. These are **not** UP Indus sites: Lothal and Dholavira (**Gujarat**), Kalibangan (**Rajasthan** (थार)), Manda (**Jammu & Kashmir**), and Mohenjo-daro (**Sindh**).
15. Key Harappan site matches: **Balu** (Haryana), **Manda** (मांडा) (Jammu & Kashmir), **Padri** (Gujarat), and **Hulas** (Saharanpur, Uttar Pradesh).
16. Boat / dock evidence appears at **Mohenjo-daro** (मोहनजोदड़ो) and **Lothal. Kalibangan** holds the famous **ploughed-field** evidence.
17. Primary Indus agricultural crops included **wheat**, **barley**, and **cotton** (cultivated earliest in the subcontinent); widespread rice cultivation expanded later in the eastern Gangetic valley during the later Vedic period.
18. The **Arthashastra** (अर्थशास्त्र) shows state interest in agriculture and craft regulation. **Sreni** are craft **guilds. Nanadesi** were itinerant "many-country" merchants.
19. **Chanhudaro** (चन्हूदड़ो) served as a specialized Indus bead-making and craft workshop centre; silver and copper punch-marked coins (*karshapanas*) served as the primary currency under the Mauryas, whereas the Guptas issued magnificent die-struck gold coins known as **dinara** (दीनार).
20. **Wootz steel** represents the renowned crucible high-carbon steel developed in ancient South India and traded across the ancient Mediterranean and West Asian worlds.

21. **Mathura** is the red-sandstone school home in UP. **Sarnath** is known for the **Lion Capital** and the Gupta Buddha. **Bhitargaon** is a Gupta brick temple in the Kanpur belt.
22. **Ahichhatra** (अहिच्छत्र) and **Kaushambi** (कौशांबी) are terracotta and urban craft centres of Uttar Pradesh.
23. Indus cities are **urban brick** with seals and drains. Early **Rigvedic** society is largely **pastoral**. Do not treat the two as one culture stage.
24. Terracotta mother-goddess and plough models differ from bronze: the **Dancing Girl** is **lost-wax bronze**, not terracotta.
25. Punch-marked coins are irregular silver or copper pieces. Gupta **dinara** are die-struck **gold**. Do not call every ancient coin a dinara.
26. The inscription of **Sarnath** on the UNESCO World Heritage list (**2026**) affirms the global significance of its Dhamek Stupa, Ashokan Lion Capital, and classical Gupta sculpture school.

📋 Must-score facts — Indus, schools, UP sites

Culture spine

Phase	Correct
Bhimbetka	Prehistoric rock art
Indus (~2600–1900 BCE)	Seals, terracotta, Dancing Girl (lost-wax), drains
Mauryan	NBPW; Chunar polish; Barabar rock-cut
Shunga	Bharhut / early Sanchi (aniconic)
Kushan	Gandhara + Mathura Buddha images
Gupta	Sarnath Buddha peak; structural temples begin

Sculpture schools

School	Correct
Gandhara	Grey **schist**; Greco-Roman; NW (≠ UP)
Mathura	Red **sandstone**; indigenous; **UP**
Amaravati	**Limestone** narrative; Andhra
Gupta Sarnath	Dharmachakra mudra; transparent robe

UP Indus / craft

Site	Correct
Alamgirpur	Easternmost Indus (Meerut)
Mandi / Hulas	UP (≠ Rakhigarhi Haryana)
Sanauli	Baghpat; Late Harappan / OCP chariots
Stupa vs chaitya	Solid relic mound vs rock-cut prayer hall
Balu / Manda / Padri / Hulas	Haryana / J&K / Gujarat / **UP**

Topic 11 — Medieval Indian Cultural History

Consolidated Must-Score Facts

1. **Humayun** brought Persian (फ़ारसी) masters **Mir Sayyid (सैयद) Ali** and **Abdus Samad. Akbar** built the **kitabkhana** (किताबखाना) and the illustrated **Razmnama (रज्मनामा). Jahangir (जहाँगीर)** favoured naturalism under painters such as **Mansur**. Under Aurangzeb (औरंगजेब) many painters left the imperial atelier.
2. Sultanate architecture spine: **Qutub** (कुतुब) under Aibak–Iltutmish (इल्तुतमिश), **Alai Darwaza** (अलाई दरवाज़ा) under the Khaljis, and **Jaunpur (जौनपुर) Sharqi** (जौनपुर शर्की) work such as **Atala Masjid** (अटाला मस्जिद).
3. Mughal architecture spine: **Humayun's Tomb** at Delhi with **charbagh** (चारबाग़), **Fatehpur Sikri** under Akbar, and the **Taj Mahal** under Shah Jahan (शाहजहाँ) at Agra.
4. Tomb locations of the Great Mughals: **Babur** (बाबर) is buried in **Kabul** (Bagh-e Babur), **Humayun** in **Delhi**, **Jahangir** (जहाँगीर) at Shahdara in **Lahore**, and **Shah Jahan** alongside Mumtaz Mahal (मुमताज महल) in **Agra** (Taj Mahal, the only one among these located in Uttar Pradesh (उत्तर प्रदेश)).
5. **Buland Darwaza** at Fatehpur Sikri marks Akbar's (अकबर) **Gujarat victory**. It is **not** a monument for Jahangir's birth in **1569**.
6. **Babur** wrote his memoir (*Tuzuk-i-Baburi* (तुजुक-ए-बाबरी)) in **Chagatai (चगताई) Turki (तुर्की)**. The Mughal **court language** was **Persian**. Do not swap the two.
7. **Abul Fazl** (अबुल फजल) wrote the narrative **Akbarnama** (अकबरनामा) and the gazetteer **Ain-i-Akbari (आइन-ए-अकबरी). Faizi (फैजी)** was the court poet. **Nakhshabi** wrote the *Tutinama*.
8. Key Mughal court chronology of deaths: **Faizi (1595)** → **Sheikh Mubarak (1597)** → **Abul Fazl (1602)** → **Prince Daniyal (1604)**.
9. Sultanate **iqta** (इक्ता) gave revenue to a **muqti** (मुक़्ती) to raise troops. **Khalsa** (खालसा) was crown land under **direct** state control. A **jagir** (जागीर) is a revenue assignment, not Khalsa.
10. Akbar's **mansab** (मनसब) had **zat** (जात) (personal rank) and **sawar** (सवार) (cavalry contingent). The original mansab system was **not hereditary** (गैर-वंशानुगत).
11. **Zabt** (जब्त) is measured land assessment. **Dahsala** (दहसाला) is Todar Mal (टोडर मल)'s **ten-year** average revenue system from about **1580**.
12. The copper **dam** (दाम) continued from Sher Shah (शेरशाह) into Akbar's currency (Sher Shah ratio: 1 Rupee = 64 Dams; Akbar ratio: 1 Rupee = 40 Dams). Akbar organised **12 subas** in 1580 (*Ain-i-Akbari*), expanding to **15 subas** with Deccan annexations (Berar, Khandesh, Ahmadnagar); later 18 under Shah Jahan and 21 under Aurangzeb.
13. **Ibadat Khana** (इबादत खाना) debates began at Fatehpur Sikri in **1575. Sulh-i-kul (सुलह-ए-कुल)** was the public peace policy. **Din-i-Ilahi** (दीन-ए-इलाही) of **1582** was a private fellowship, not a state religion.
14. Akbar abolished **jizya** (जज़िया) in **1564**. The **Mahzar** of **1579** asserted Akbar's authority in religious disputes.
15. Celebrated members of Akbar's nine jewels (*Navaratnas*) include musical maestro **Tansen** (तानसेन) (recruited from King Ramchandra of Rewa/Bhata), finance minister **Raja (राजा) Todar Mal**, court wit **Birbal** (बीरबल) (Mahesh Das), chief ideologue **Abul Fazl**, and poet laureate **Faizi** (फैजी).
16. Uttar Pradesh architecture: **Jaunpur** Sharqi (Atala, Lal Darwaza), **Agra** Fort–Itimad-ud-Daulah (इतिमाद-उद-दौला)–Taj–Ram Bagh, and **Fatehpur Sikri** (Buland Darwaza, Ibadat Khana, Salim Chishti (चिश्ती)).
17. **Tulsidas** (तुलसीदास) wrote the Awadhi (अवधी) *Ramcharitmanas* (रामचरितमानस) in Akbar's age. **Kavindra Acharya** of Banaras is linked to Shah Jahan's court culture.
18. These are **not** UP tombs: Babur at Kabul, Jahangir at Lahore, Humayun at Delhi.
19. Medieval painting moved from Sultanate book-art into the Mughal **kitabkhana**, then outward to Rajput (राजपूत) and Pahari (पहाड़ी) courts as imperial patronage shifted.
20. **Alai Darwaza** is an Alauddin Khalji (अलाउद्दीन खिलजी) gateway at the Qutub complex. It is not a Sharqi Jaunpur monument.
21. **Fatehpur Sikri** is Akbar's planned capital near Agra. It holds Buland Darwaza and the Ibadat Khana, not Shah Jahan's Taj.

22. **Akbarnama** tells the reign story. **Ain-i-Akbari** (आइन-ए-अकबरी) is the administrative and statistical companion. Papers often swap the two titles.
23. **Zat** ranks the man's personal status. **Sawar** ranks the horsemen he must maintain. High zat with low sawar is a classic trap pattern.
24. **Iqta** revenue stayed with the muqti for troops. **Khalsa** revenue went to the treasury under direct officials. Do not call jagirs "direct crown land."
25. Persian was the language of farmans, chronicles, and court poetry after Babur. Turki remained Babur's personal memoir tongue, not later court speech.
26. **Din-i-Ilahi** never replaced Islam as state religion. **Sulh-i-kul** (सुलह-ए-कुल) is the broader public tolerance policy examined more often than the private cult.
27. **Jaunpur** Sharqi architecture (शर्की स्थापत्य) is a regional Sultanate style of eastern UP. It is not Delhi Slave or Khalji architecture.
28. In medieval cultural historiography, **Azizuddin Khan** is noted for translating Sanskrit texts during Firoz Shah (फ़िरोज़ शाह) Tughlaq (फिरोज शाह तुगलक)'s Nagarkot/Kangra (कांगड़ा) campaign (*Dalail-i-Firoz Shahi*); he is distinct from Abul Fazl's Mughal court histories.

📋 Must-score facts — painting, architecture, admin culture

Painting / books

Item	Correct
Humayun masters	Mir Sayyid Ali, Abdus Samad
Akbar	Kitabkhana; illustrated atelier
Baburnama (बाबरनामा) language	**Chagatai Turki** (court = **Persian**)
Abul Fazl	*Akbarnama* (narrative) + *Ain-i-Akbari* (gazetteer)
Death order	Faizi 1595 → Mubarak 1597 → Abul Fazl 1602 → Daniyal 1604

Architecture / tombs

Item	Correct
Sultanate spine	Qutub → Alai Darwaza → Jaunpur Sharqi
Mughal spine	Humayun's Tomb (charbagh) → Fatehpur Sikri → Taj
Tomb places	Babur **Kabul** · Humayun **Delhi** · Jahangir **Lahore** · Shah Jahan **Agra**
Buland Darwaza	Akbar's **Gujarat victory** (≠ Jahangir birth)

Admin culture tags

Term	Correct
Iqta / Khalsa	Muqti revenue / crown land
Mansab	Zat + sawar (not originally hereditary)
Zabt / Dahsala	Measurement / Todar Mal 10-year average (~1580)
Dam	Copper coin (मुद्रा) Sher Shah → Akbar

Topic 12 — Sculpture

Consolidated — 30 Must-Score Facts

1. Indian sculpture timeline: Indus (सिंधु) bronze and terracotta (पकी मिट्टी) → **Mauryan polish** (मौर्य) → **Bharhut (भरहुत) / Sanchi (सांची)** relief → Kushan (कुषाण) **Gandhara + Mathura** → **Amaravati** → **Gupta Sarnath** (गुप्त) → temple walls → **Chola (चोल) bronze** (चोल).
2. **Gandhara** school uses grey **schist** and Greco-Roman / Hellenistic modelling in the north-west. It is not an Uttar Pradesh school.
3. **Mathura** (मथुरा) school uses red or spotted **sandstone**, indigenous modelling, and sits in **Uttar Pradesh**. It cuts Buddha (बुद्ध) and Tirthankara images.
4. **Amaravati** school uses **limestone** narrative panels in Andhra. It is free narrative relief more than Mathura's freestanding icons.
5. **Gupta Sarnath Buddha (सारनाथ)** shows **dharmachakra** (धर्मचक्र) mudra, a transparent robe, and spiritual calm. It differs from heavy-volume Kushan Mathura figures.
6. Early Buddhist art is **aniconic** (अनैकोनिक) (wheel, tree, empty throne). The **human Buddha** image becomes common from the **Kushan** (कुषाण) age.
7. Key mudras: **dharmachakra** (teaching), **bhumisparsha** (भूमिसपर्श) (earth-touching), **abhaya** (अभय) (fearlessness), **dhyana** (ध्यान) (meditation), and **varada** (वरद) (boon).
8. Landmark temple sculpture traditions: **Khajuraho** (खजुराहो) (sensuous Chandela (चंदेल) *mithuna* couples on Nagara (नागर) sandstone), **Konark (कोणार्क) Sun Temple** (conceived as Surya's chariot carved with **24 wheels** and pulled by **7 horses**), **Mahabalipuram** (महाबलिपुरम्) (monumental Pallava (पल्लव) open-air granite reliefs such as Arjuna's Penance), and **Hoysala** temples (intricate, jewel-like chloritic schist/soapstone carvings).
9. Stone map: **Chunar** (चुनार) polish stone in UP, Mathura **red sandstone**, Gandhara **schist**, Amaravati **limestone**, Hoysala **chloritic schist**, and much South Indian temple work in **granite**.
10. **Mauryan polish** is the mirror Chunar surface. Gupta finish (गुप्त) is smooth idealism, not the same mirror polish.
11. The **Didarganj Yakshi** (दिदारगंज यक्षी) (chauri-bearer) from Patna is the classic Mauryan polish Yakshi. She is a Yakshi, not a Buddha.
12. The **Parkham Yaksha** from the Mathura region is a colossal early stone guardian feeding the indigenous icon tradition.
13. Masterpieces of Indian metallurgy include the prehistoric (प्रागैतिहासिक) Indus **Dancing Girl** cast in bronze via the **lost-wax** (लॉस्ट-वैक्स) technique, exquisite South Indian **Chola Nataraja** (चोल नटराज) processional bronzes, eastern Indian **Pala** Buddhist bronze icons, and indigenous central/eastern tribal (आदिवासी) **Dhokra** (ढोकरा) bell-metal castings.
14. The **Sultanganj Buddha** is a colossal copper image from Bihar, now in the British Museum. It is Pala-age metal, not a Chola Nataraja.
15. Pala–Sena Buddhist bronzes of Buddha, Tara (तारा), and Avalokiteshvara centre on the **Nalanda** (नालंदा) orbit of Bihar–Bengal with dark polished metal.
16. **Nataraja** holds **damaru** (डमरु) and fire, shows **abhaya** and **gajahasta**, places the right foot on **Apasmara** (अपस्मार), and stands in a **prabhamandala** (प्रभामंडल).
17. Uttar Pradesh sculpture homes: **Mathura** school, **Sarnath** (सारनाथ) Lion Capital and Gupta Buddha, **Chunar** polish stone, and terracotta at **Ahichhatra** (अहिच्छत्र) and **Kaushambi** (कौशांबी).
18. **Lion Capital** of Sarnath: four (चार) lions back to back; abacus with horse, bull, elephant, and lion plus **dharmachakra**. It became the **National Emblem** in **1950**.
19. The **2026** inscription of **Sarnath** on the UNESCO World Heritage list highlights its status as the cradle of the classical Gupta sculpture school and home of the Mauryan Lion Capital.
20. **Bharhut** is **Shunga** (शुंग), not Mauryan. Early **Sanchi** remains largely aniconic before later iconic (साकार) additions.

21. Beyond Buddhist icons at Sarnath, classical Gupta Hindu sculpture is exemplified by the colossal rock-cut (शैलकट) **Varaha cave relief at Udayagiri (उदयगिरि)** (Madhya Pradesh) and the **Sheshashayi Vishnu panel at Deogarh (देवगढ़)** (Lalitpur, UP).
22. **Khajuraho**, **Sanchi**, **Konark** (कोणार्क), Chola bronze, and **Didarganj** are outside Uttar Pradesh. Gandhara and Amaravati are also not UP schools.
23. Mathura Kushan (कुषाण) figures are heavier in volume. Gupta Sarnath figures look lighter, calmer, and more spiritual. That contrast is a standard school trap.
24. **Chola Nataraja** is a South Indian temple processional bronze. The Indus **Dancing Girl** is a tiny lost-wax figurine from Harappa-age craft, not Shiva Nataraja.
25. **Konark** is the Ganga-period Sun chariot temple of Odisha. **Khajuraho** is the Chandela complex of Madhya Pradesh. Do not swap region or dynasty.
26. Freestanding Mathura icons differ from Amaravati's long narrative limestone panels around the stupa.
27. Buddhist sculpture moves from symbol to person: aniconic Maurya (मौर्य)–Shunga signs, then Kushan human Buddha, then Gupta ideal Buddha at Sarnath.
28. **Ahichhatra** and **Kaushambi** are the UP terracotta homes. They are craft-and-figurine centres, not Gandhara schist ateliers.
29. Do not swap Pala bronzes with Chola **Nataraja** processional icons or with tribal **Dhokra**.
30. Hellenised Gandhara drapery and wavy hair mark Greco-Buddhist influence. Mathura's spotted red sandstone stays the indigenous UP counter-school.

📋 Must-score facts — schools, mudras, materials

Timeline / schools

School	Material / tag
Mauryan polish	Mirror **Chunar** surface
Bharhut / Sanchi	Shunga relief; early **aniconic**
Gandhara	Grey **schist**; Greco-Roman
Mathura	Red **sandstone**; **UP**
Amaravati	**Limestone** narrative
Gupta Sarnath	Ideal calm Buddha; dharmachakra

Mudras / bronze

Mudra	Meaning
Dharmachakra	Teaching
Bhumisparsha	Earth-touching
Abhaya	Fearlessness
Dhyana	Meditation
Item	Correct
------	------
Human Buddha image	Common from **Kushan** age
Dancing Girl	Indus **lost-wax** bronze
Chola Nataraja	Processional bronze; damaru + fire; foot on Apasmara
Stone map	Mathura red sandstone · Gandhara schist · Hoysala soapstone teaching

Topic 13 — Folk Culture

Consolidated Must-Score Facts

1. **Folk art** (लोक कला) is community, oral, and ritual (कर्मकाण्ड). It is not a Natyashastra (नाट्यशास्त्र) classical school like Bharatanatyam (भरतनाट्यम्) or a court Mughal (मुग़ल) miniature (लघु चित्र) atelier.
2. **Madhubani** (मधुबनी) belongs to Mithila in Bihar. It is bright geometric work and carries a **GI**. It is not a named UNESCO ICH element by itself.
3. **Warli** (वारली) belongs to Maharashtra. It is tribal (आदिवासी) white-on-red painting. Do not place Warli in Bihar or Uttar Pradesh.
4. **Pattachitra** (पट्टचित्र) belongs to Odisha.
5. **Phad** (फड़) belongs to Rajasthan.
6. **Gond** (गोंड) belongs to Madhya Pradesh.
7. **Kalamkari** (कलमकारी) belongs to Andhra Pradesh.
8. **Sanjhi** (सांझी) belongs to Mathura (मथुरा)–Vrindavan (वृंदावन) in Uttar Pradesh. It is paper-cutting and now carries a GI.
9. **Phulkari** (फुलकारी) belongs to Punjab.
10. **Pithora** (पिथौरा) is Rathwa wall painting of Gujarat.
11. **Saura** (सौरा) is Odisha wall-icon painting, also called *idital* (इडिटाल).
12. **Cheriyal** (चेरियल) is Telangana narrative scroll painting.
13. **Kalighat** (कालीघाट) is Kolkata patachitra watercolour of West Bengal.
14. **Rogan** (रोगन) is boiled-castor-oil fabric art of Kutch.
15. **Aipan** (ऐपण) is ritual floor and wall art of Uttarakhand (उत्तराखंड).
16. **Mandana** (मांडना) is festive chalk design of Rajasthan.
17. Core folk and tribal belief traditions include village shrine deities (**Gramdevta (ग्रामदेवता) / Kuldevi**), serpent (सर्प) reverence (**Nag Panchami**), riverine Sun worship (**Chhath** (छठ) in eastern UP and Bihar), traditional spirit healers (**Ojha**), and indigenous sacred groves (पवित्र उपवन) and animist faiths including **Sarna** (सरना) (Chota Nagpur), **Donyi-Polo** (दोन्यी-पोलो) (Arunachal Pradesh), and **Sanamahi** (सनामही) (Manipur).
18. **Handloom** is cloth woven on a manual loom. Yarn may be mill-spun. **Khadi** (खादी) is **hand-spun and** hand-woven under **KVIC (MSME)**.
19. **Handicraft** is a handmade object such as pottery, metalwork, or embroidery. It is not the same word as handloom cloth.
20. National **Handloom Day** is **7 August**, recalling the **1905** Swadeshi (स्वदेशी) moment; the first observance was **2015**. India Handloom Brand started in **2015**. Handloom Mark is from **2006**.
21. Development Commissioner (Handicrafts) sits under **Textiles**. **PEHCHAN** (पहचान) artisan cards began in **2016**. **e-Pehchan** is the handloom digital ID from **2025**. **Shilp Guru** (शिल्प गुरु) is the top handicraft honour.
22. **GI** is governed by the **1999** Act. The Registry is at **Chennai** under **DPIIT / Commerce**, not Culture and not Textiles. First Indian GI was **Darjeeling Tea (दार्जिलिंग चाय) (2004)**. Protection is about **10 years** and renewable.
23. **Banarasi** (बनारसी) brocade belongs to Varanasi (वाराणसी).
24. **Chikankari** (चिकनकारी) and **Zardozi** (ज़रदोज़ी) belong to Lucknow (लखनऊ).
25. **Bhadohi** is known for carpets. **Moradabad** is known for brass. **Firozabad** is known for glass. **Khurja** is known for pottery. **Kannauj** (कन्नौज) is known for attar.
26. **Saharanpur** is known for carved woodwork. **Agra** (आगरा) is known for marble inlay (*parchin kari*). **Pilkhuwa** is known for hand-block printing. **Nizamabad** is known for black-clay pottery.
27. **Blue Pottery** is **Jaipur**, not Lucknow. **Pushkar Fair** (पुष्कर मेला) is Rajasthan. **Surajkund** (सूरजकुंड) crafts mela is Haryana.

28. **Ramlila** (रामलीला) and **Nautanki** (नौटंकी) are Uttar Pradesh folk theatre. **Raslila** (रासलीला) is a Braj (ब्रज) folk play. It is not Manipuri (मणिपुरी) classical dance.
29. Handlooms and handicrafts sit under the **Ministry of Textiles**. The GI Registry sits under **Commerce (DPIIT)**. **KVIC** sits under **MSME**. Zonal Cultural Centres, IGNCA (कला केंद्र), and festival grants sit under **Culture**.
30. **North Central Zone Cultural Centre** is at **Prayagraj** (प्रयागराज).
31. **Sant Kabir Award** (संत कबीर) is the highest **handloom** weaver honour. **Shilp Guru** is the highest **handicraft** artisan honour. Do not swap the two.
32. **Chikankari** is Lucknow white-thread embroidery on muslin. **Zardozi** is metallic-thread court embroidery, also strong in Lucknow.
33. **Powerloom** (पावरलूम) is machine mass weave. **Handloom** is manual loom weave. Powerloom cloth is often offered as a false "handloom" option.
34. A **GI tag** (भौगोलिक संकेत) protects place-linked community quality. A **trademark** (व्यापार चिह्न) protects one firm's brand. GI is not a private logo.
35. **Surajkund** is the February crafts fair of Haryana. **Pushkar Fair** is the Kartik camel fair of Rajasthan. **Pushkar Kumbh (कुंभ) 2025** (पुष्कर कुंभ) was at Mana (माना) in Uttarakhand.
36. Folk tradition (लोक परंपरा) is a custom passed socially. Folk belief (लोक विश्वास) is the village supernatural worldview. Both sit under folk culture but answer different stems.
37. These are not Uttar Pradesh: Pushkar Fair (Rajasthan), Pushkar Kumbh 2025 (Uttarakhand), Surajkund (Haryana), Blue Pottery (Jaipur), Warli (Maharashtra), Madhubani (Bihar).
38. **Banarasi Brocade** is Varanasi's premier handloom GI. **Chikankari** is Lucknow's embroidery GI.
39. **Phad** is Rajasthan scroll painting. **Pattachitra** is Odisha cloth or palm-leaf painting, sometimes also Bengal. Do not dump every scroll into Madhubani.
40. Uttar Pradesh leads India's GI count in recent tallies, about **81** by late **2025**. Craft–city matching stays high-yield.

📋 Must-score facts — folk painting, handloom, GI

Painting ↔ region

Art	Region
Madhubani	Bihar Mithila (GI)
Warli	**Maharashtra** (≠ Bihar/UP)
Pattachitra	Odisha
Phad	Rajasthan
Gond	Central India
Sanjhi	Braj / Mathura–Vrindavan (**UP**; GI)
Kalighat	West Bengal
Cheriyal	Telangana

Craft / scheme tags

Item	Correct
Folk vs classical	Community/oral/ritual ≠ Natyashastra court school
Handloom vs khadi	Manual loom cloth vs **hand-spun + hand-woven** (KVIC)
Handicraft	Handmade object (≠ handloom cloth)
Handloom Day	**7 August** (1905 Swadeshi recall; first **2015**)
GI Act / Registry	**1999**; **Chennai**; DPIIT/Commerce (≠ **Culture**)

Item	Correct
PEHCHAN	Artisan cards from **2016**

Topic 14 — Cultural Heritage

Consolidated Must-Score Facts

1. **Tangible** cultural heritage is a monument or site you can touch. **Intangible** cultural heritage is a living practice or skill you perform.
2. The World Heritage Convention is **1972** for sites with Outstanding Universal Value. The Intangible Heritage Convention is **2003** for living traditions. **Ramsar (रामसर) 1971** is wetlands, not WHS.
3. The World Heritage Committee of **21** states decides inscriptions. **ICOMOS** advises on cultural sites. **IUCN** (आईयूसीएन) advises on natural sites. **OUV** is required.
4. India has **45** World Heritage Sites: about **37** cultural, **7** natural, and **1** mixed (**Khangchendzonga**, Sikkim).
5. Uttar Pradesh has **four** (चातुर्याम) WHS: **Taj Mahal (ताज महल) (1983)**, **Agra Fort (आगरा किला) (1983)**, **Fatehpur Sikri (फतेहपुर सीकरी) (1986)**, and **Sarnath (2026)**.
6. **Varanasi (वाराणसी) ghats** (वाराणसी घाट) remain on the **Tentative** List only. Do not count them as a fifth UP World Heritage Site.
7. Recent India inscriptions: **Moidams** (Assam, **2024**), **Maratha Military Landscapes** (**2025**), and **Sarnath** (**2026**). Earlier pairs include Santiniketan and Hoysala (**2023**) and Dholavira (धोलावीरा) and Ramappa (रामप्पा) (**2021**).
8. India has **16** UNESCO ICH elements. Early Masterpiece proclamations were **Kutiyattam 2001**, **Vedic chanting 2003**, and **Ramlila (रामलीला) 2005**; all three entered the Representative List (प्रतिनिधि) in **2008**.
9. Recent inscriptions on the UNESCO ICH list include: **Yoga (योग) (2016)**, **Kumbh (कुंभ) Mela (कुंभ मेला) (2017)**, **Durga (दुर्गा) Puja of Kolkata (2021)**, **Garba (गरबा) of Gujarat (2023)**, and **Deepavali (2025)**.
10. These are **not** named UNESCO ICH elements: **Bharatanatyam** (भरतनाट्यम्), **Kathak** (कथक), **Nautanki** (नौटंकी), and **Holi** (होली) as a standalone Indian element.
11. **World Heritage Day** (18 अप्रैल) (International Day for Monuments and Sites) is celebrated on **18 April** under ICOMOS; the UNESCO Intangible Cultural Heritage Convention was adopted (अंगीकृत) on **17 October 2003** (ratified by India in **2005**).
12. Cultural WHS (सांस्कृतिक) use criteria **i–vi**. Natural WHS (प्राकृतिक) use **vii–x**. Mixed sites need both sets. India has only one mixed site: Khangchendzonga.
13. The **Representative List** shows living identity. The **Urgent Safeguarding List** (तात्कालिक संरक्षण) is for endangered ICH needing emergency action.
14. The **Tentative List** (अस्थायी) is India's proposed pipeline. The **Inscribed List** (अंकित) is the official World Heritage roll.
15. An **ASI** (पुरातत्व सर्वेक्षण) monument under AMASR **1958** is national protection. It is **not** automatically a UNESCO World Heritage Site.
16. **Keoladeo** (केवलादेव) is both a natural WHS and a Ramsar wetland. Most Ramsar sites are not World Heritage Sites.
17. **Ramlila (2008)** is the UP-centred ICH performance. **Kumbh (2017)** includes Prayagraj (प्रयागराज) among the four bathing sites.
18. Lucknow (लखनऊ)'s **Imambara** and **Residency** are important heritage but **not** World Heritage Sites.
19. These are outside UP: **Khajuraho** (खजुराहो), **Sanchi** (सांची), **Bhimbetka** (भीमबेटका), **Keoladeo**, and **Qutub** (कुतुब) (Delhi).
20. **Sarnath WHS** (सारनाथ) is the **2026** inscription and UP's fourth site. **Varanasi ghats** are still Tentative. Do not merge the two.
21. **Ramlila** is intangible performance heritage. The **Taj Mahal** (ताज महल) is tangible tomb heritage from **1983**. Papers love this swap.
22. Masterpiece proclamation years (**2001 / 2003 / 2005**) are not the same as the common Representative List year (प्रतिनिधि सूची) **2008** for those three elements.

23. Convention year order s: Ramsar **1971**, World Heritage **1972**, ICH **2003**, India ICH ratification **2005**.
24. **Deepavali** entered UNESCO ICH on **10 December 2025** as India's **16th** element. It is intangible festival heritage, not a monument inscription.
25. **Qutub Minar** (कुतुब मीनार) is a Delhi WHS, not an Uttar Pradesh site. **Khajuraho** is Madhya Pradesh, not UP.
26. Tangible vs intangible is the first filter: if you can walk into it as a monument, it is tangible; if you perform it as living culture, it is intangible.

📋 Must-score facts — WHS, ICH, UP sites

Conventions / India counts

Item	Correct
Tangible vs intangible	Monument you can touch vs living practice
WHS Convention / ICH	**1972** / **2003**
WH Committee	**21** states; ICOMOS cultural / IUCN natural
India WHS	**45** (~37 cultural, 7 natural, 1 mixed)
Mixed site	**Khangchendzonga** (Sikkim) only
Criteria	Cultural **i–vi**; natural **vii–x**

UP WHS / ICH

Site	Year
Taj Mahal / Agra Fort	**1983**
Fatehpur Sikri	**1986**
Sarnath	**2026**
Varanasi ghats	**Tentative only** (not a 5th WHS)
ICH element	Year
---	---
Kutiyattam / Vedic chanting	2001 / 2003
Yoga / Kumbh	**2016** / **2017**
Durga Puja Kolkata / Garba	**2021** / **2023**

Not named UNESCO ICH: Bharatanatyam, Kathak, Nautanki, Holi (standalone).

Topic 15 — Archaeology

Consolidated Must-Score Facts

1. **Archaeology** studies material remains through excavation (उत्खनन) and dating. **History** (इतिहास) builds narrative mainly from written sources. The two work together but are not the same method.
2. **Stratigraphy** (स्तरिकी) uses the law of superposition: a lower undisturbed layer is older. **Typology** (प्रकारिकी) compares artefact styles across sites.
3. **Vertical** excavation reads time sequence. **Horizontal** excavation reads one-period layout. Wheeler (व्हीलर)'s **box-grid** kept **balks** between squares.
4. **Radiocarbon (C-14 (कार्बन-14))** dates **organic** carbon only. It does not date a stone seal (मुद्रा) directly. **Thermoluminescence** (ताप-संदीप्ति) dates fired clay or brick.
5. **ASI** began in **1861** with **Alexander (सिकंदर) Cunningham** as first Director General. It sits under the Culture ministry (संस्कृति). Digging needs licence under **AMASR 1958**.
6. Indus (सिंधु) discovery chain: Cunningham notes a seal in **1853** → **Daya Ram Sahni (साहनी)** excavates **Harappa** (हड़प्पा) in **1921** → **R. D. Banerji** excavates **Mohenjo-daro** (मोहनजोदड़ो) in **1922** → **John Marshall (मार्शल)** announces the civilisation in **1924** → **Wheeler** brings scientific grid methods in **1946**.
7. Do not swap excavators: **Sahni = Harappa**, **Banerji = Mohenjo-daro**. Marshall announces; Wheeler reforms method.
8. Indus geography: Harappa (Pakistan Punjab), Mohenjo-daro (Sindh), **Dholavira** (धोलावीरा) and **Lothal** (लोथल) (Gujarat), **Kalibangan** (कालीबंगा) (Rajasthan), **Rakhigarhi** (राखीगढ़ी) (Haryana, largest in India, **not UP**).
9. Uttar Pradesh Indus sites: **Alamgirpur** (आलमगीरपुर) (easternmost, Meerut (मेरठ)), **Mandi** (मंडी), **Hulas** (हुलास) (Saharanpur belt), and **Santhali** (Bijnor).
10. **Mandi** and **Hulas** are UP. **Rakhigarhi** is Haryana. That state split is a standing prelims trap.
11. Key Harappan (हड़प्पा) geographical correlations: **Balu** (Haryana), **Manda** (मांडा) (Jammu & Kashmir), **Padri** (Gujarat), and **Hulas** (Uttar Pradesh).
12. Maritime and shipping evidence appears at **Mohenjo-daro** (terracotta (पकी मिट्टी) boat amulets) and **Lothal** (the world's earliest tidal dockyard (गोदीबाड़ा)); **Dholavira** is distinguished by monumental stone water reservoirs and a ten-symbol inscription signboard.
13. Prehistoric (प्रागैतिहासिक) matchs include **Nevasa** (Maharashtra), **Isampur** (Karnataka), **Didwana** (Rajasthan), and **Gudiyam** (Tamil Nadu (तमिलनाडु)).
14. **Bhimbetka** (भीमबेटका) was identified by **V. S. Wakankar (वाकणकर)** in **1957** in **Madhya Pradesh**. It is prehistoric rock shelter (शैल आश्रय) art, not a Harappan city.
15. **Sanauli** (सनौली) in **Baghpat, UP**, excavated around **2018**, is the late Harappan / OCP **chariot** site. It is not the easternmost Indus city.
16. Early historic (ऐतिहासिक) UP sites include **Sarnath**, **Hastinapur** (हस्तिनापुर), **Kaushambi** (कौशांबी), **Ahichhatra** (अहिच्छत्र), and **Shravasti**.
17. Crucial prehistoric archaeological complexes in Uttar Pradesh include the **Belan Valley** (Palaeolithic to Neolithic (नवपाषाण) sequence, including Koldihwa (कोलडिहवा)), and Pratapgarh's Mesolithic habitation-burial sites at **Sarai Nahar Rai** (सराय नाहर राय), **Mahadaha**, and **Damdama**.
18. **In-situ** (स्थान पर) conservation keeps remains on the mound. **Ex-situ** (स्थानांतरित) moves objects to a museum. Both appear in heritage management stems.
19. **BSIP Lucknow** is named for aDNA work linked to recent Rakhigarhi skeletal study. The bones themselves are from **Haryana**, not from a UP Indus city.
20. Excavator spine: Cunningham (seal / ASI), Sahni (Harappa), Banerji (Mohenjo-daro), Marshall (announcement / mass dig), Wheeler (1946 grid), Wakankar (Bhimbetka), **S. R. Rao** (Lothal), **R. S. Bisht** (Dholavira), **B. B. Lal** (Kalibangan–Hastinapur).

21. **Manda** (on the Chenab (चिनाब) in Jammu & Kashmir) marks the northern frontier of the Indus Valley (सिंधु घाटी) Civilisation, whereas **Alamgirpur** (on the Hindon in Meerut, UP) marks its easternmost frontier.
22. Archaeology dates by layers and materials. A stone seal needs associated organic samples or other methods; bare C-14 on stone is a false option.
23. **Harappa** and **Mohenjo-daro** are the twin discovery cities of the 1920s. Later famous Indian sites fill the Gujarat–Rajasthan–Haryana–UP map.
24. **Kalibangan** is famous for the ploughed field and fire altars in Rajasthan. Do not place Kalibangan in Uttar Pradesh.
25. **Dholavira** is a Gujarat Harappan city with water systems and a signboard. **Lothal** is the dockyard city of Gujarat. Keep both in Gujarat, not in UP.
26. Rakhigarhi remains Haryana even when laboratories in Lucknow or Kolkata study its bones. Lab location does not move the site's state.

📋 Must-score facts — methods, ASI, Indus excavators

Method tags

Item	Correct
Stratigraphy	Lower undisturbed layer = older
Vertical / horizontal dig	Time sequence / one-period layout
C-14	**Organic** carbon only (not bare stone)
TL	Fired pottery / ceramics
ASI	**1861**; first DG **Cunningham**; Culture ministry

Excavator ↔ site

Person	Site
Daya Ram Sahni	**Harappa 1921**
R.D. Banerji	**Mohenjo-daro 1922**
John Marshall	Announced civilization
Mortimer Wheeler	Method reform (≠ discoverer)

Geography traps

Site	State
Alamgirpur	UP — easternmost
Mandi / Hulas	**UP**
Rakhigarhi	**Haryana** (largest in India)
Balu / Manda / Padri / Hulas	Haryana / J&K / Gujarat / UP
Lothal / Dholavira	Gujarat (dock / reservoirs)

Topic 16 — Awards, Personalities & GI Tags

Consolidated — 34 Must-Score Facts

1. Three Culture akademis sit at Rabindra Bhavan: **Sangeet Natak Akademi (1952)** for performing arts, **Sahitya Akademi (1954)** for letters, and **Lalit Kala Akademi (1954)** for visual arts.
2. SNA (संगीत नाटक) gives the annual **Akademi Award** (अकादेमी पुरस्कार), the lifetime **Akademi Ratna (अकादेमी रत्न) (Fellowship)** for a small living cohort, and the **Bismillah Khan (बिस्मिल्लाह खान) Yuva** (बिस्मिल्लाह खान युवा) award for young performing artists.
3. Sahitya Akademi works in **24** languages: the **22** Eighth Schedule (आठवीं अनुसूची) languages plus **English** and **Rajasthani. Bhojpuri** is not a separate Akademi language.
4. Sahitya prizes include the annual book award, Fellowship, **Yuva Puraskar (authors ≤35)**, and Bal Sahitya. Yuva ran in **23** languages in **2025** with **no Dogri** that year.
5. **Jnanpith** (ज्ञानपीठ) is given by the **Bharatiya Jnanpith** trust from **1965** (first winner **G. Sankara Kurup**). It is **not** a Sahitya Akademi award (साहित्य अकादेमी). The **58th** Jnanpith went to **Rambhadracharya** (with Gulzar).
6. Lalit Kala gives National Awards and **Kala Ratna**, runs **Triennale India**, and has a regional centre at **Lucknow** (लखनऊ). It is not the same body as **NGMA** (राष्ट्रीय आधुनिक कला गैलरी).
7. Instituted in **1954**, the **Bharat Ratna** has been conferred upon six classical/cultural musicians: **M. S. Subbulakshmi** (1998, the first musician recipient), **Pandit Ravi (रावी) Shankar** (1999), **Lata Mangeshkar** (लता) and **Ustad Bismillah Khan** (2001), **Pandit Bhimsen Joshi** (भीमसेन जोशी) (2008), and **Dr. Bhupen Hazarika** (2019, posthumous). Legendary filmmaker **Satyajit Ray** received it for cinema in **1992**.
8. These culture names are **not** Bharat Ratna: **Birju Maharaj** (बिरजू), tabla (तबला) maestro **Ustad Zakir Hussain**, and **Rabindranath Tagore (Nobel** 1913**; died** 1941**, before the award existed).
9. Dr **Zakir Husain** (Bharat Ratna **1963**) was the statesman-President. He is **not** the tabla maestro Ustad Zakir Hussain.
10. Padma order below Bharat Ratna is **Padma Vibhushan** → **Padma Bhushan** → **Padma Shri**. A Padma Vibhushan for Art is not automatic Bharat Ratna.
11. **Sahitya Yuva Puraskar** (युवा पुरस्कार) is for young authors ≤35. **Bismillah Khan Yuva** is SNA's young **performing** award. Do not swap the two Yuva names.
12. **GI** follows the **1999** Act. Registry is at **Chennai** under **DPIIT / Commerce**, not Culture. First Indian GI was **Darjeeling Tea (दार्जिलिंग टी) (2004)**. Protection is about **10 years** and renewable.
13. Culture-facing UP GIs include **Banarasi** (बनारसी) brocade and **Chikankari (चिकनकारी). Blue Pottery** is Jaipur, not UP.
14. Folk-painting GIs include **Madhubani** (Bihar), **Warli** (Maharashtra), **Pattachitra** (Odisha), and **Kalamkari** (Andhra Pradesh).
15. Other high-yield GIs outside UP crafts include **Basmati** rice, **Chanderi** saree (Madhya Pradesh), **Kanchipuram** silk (Tamil Nadu), **Mysore silk**, **Pashmina** (Jammu & Kashmir / Ladakh belt), **Alphonso** mango (Maharashtra), and **Nagpur orange**.
16. **Bismillah Khan** is the shehnai (शहनाई) maestro of **Varanasi** (वाराणसी), Bharat Ratna **2001**, and namesake of SNA Yuva. **Birju Maharaj** is Lucknow Kathak (कथक) and not Bharat Ratna.
17. Prominent UP literary figures: **Munshi Premchand** pioneered modern Hindi-Urdu realist fiction (*Godan*); **Goswami Tulsidas (तुलसीदास)** authored the epic *Ramcharitmanas* (रामचरितमानस) in Awadhi (अवधी); and spiritual scholar **Jagadguru Rambhadracharya** received the 58th Jnanpith Award for Sanskrit literature.
18. Akademi Award is the annual discipline prize. **Akademi Ratna** is the lifetime Fellowship. Papers often treat every SNA prize as Fellowship.
19. A **GI tag** (भौगोलिक संकेत) protects place-linked community quality. A **trademark** (ट्रेडमार्क चिह्न) protects one firm's brand.

20. Culture ministry (संस्कृति) runs the akademis. **Commerce / DPIIT** runs the GI Registry. Do not put GI under Culture.
21. **M. S. Subbulakshmi** is the first musician Bharat Ratna (**1998**, Carnatic (कर्नाटक)). **Lata Mangeshkar** is the playback Bharat Ratna of **2001**.
22. Sahitya Akademi's **24** languages are not identical to the **22** Eighth Schedule languages because English and Rajasthani are added.
23. Lalit Kala is the visual **academy. NGMA** is the modern-art **gallery**. Do not merge academy and gallery.
24. SNA is older (**1952**) than Sahitya and Lalit Kala (**1954**). Year order is a frequent match trap.
25. **Bharat Ratna** is the highest civilian honour; the Prime Minister recommends names to the President. It is not an akademi prize.
26. Jnanpith is a literary trust award from **1965**. Sahitya Akademi Award is the annual Culture-academy book prize. Keep trust versus academy clear.
27. While Lucknow hosts a premier Regional Centre of the Lalit Kala Akademi, National Akademi Awards are conferred strictly by the central national jury on merit.
28. Padma Vibhushan **2025** in **Art** went to **L. Subramaniam** (violin). Do not treat every Padma Art citation as Bharat Ratna.
29. **Ustad Zakir Hussain** (tabla) held Padma awards and Grammys but was **not** Bharat Ratna; he died in **December 2024**.
30. **Sant Kabir Award** is the highest handloom weaver honour (Textiles). **Shilp Guru** is the highest handicraft artisan honour. Do not swap them with akademi prizes.
31. State cultural prizes such as Madhya Pradesh's **Kalidas Samman** are state awards. They are not Bharat Ratna or Jnanpith.
32. First Indian GI remains **Darjeeling Tea (2004)**. Banarasi saree is a famous UP GI but not the first national GI.
33. GI ownership is a **community** / association claim tied to geography. A company trademark cannot replace that place-name right.
34. Filter order: first identify the body (SNA / Sahitya / Lalit Kala / Jnanpith / Bharat Ratna / Padma / GI ministry (वाणिज्य)), then the person or craft, then the year if asked.

📋 Must-score facts — akademis, Bharat Ratna, GI

Three Culture akademis (Rabindra Bhavan)

Akademi	Year / remit
Sangeet Natak	**1952** — music, dance, **theatre**
Sahitya	**1954** — literature (**24** languages)
Lalit Kala	Visual arts; National Awards; Lucknow centre

Awards / traps

Item	Correct
Sahitya languages	22 Eighth Schedule (22 अनुसूची) + English + Rajasthani (**Bhojpuri out**)
Jnanpith	Bharatiya Jnanpith trust from **1965** (≠ government akademi)
Bharat Ratna (culture)	M.S. Subbulakshmi **1998** first musician; etc.
Not Bharat Ratna	Birju Maharaj; Ustad Zakir Hussain (tabla); Tagore already Nobel era trap
Zakir Husain vs Zakir Hussain	President **1963** BR ≠ tabla maestro
Yuva Puraskar vs Bismillah Khan Yuva	Sahitya ≤35 authors / SNA young **performing**

GI

Item	Correct
Act / Registry	**1999**; **Chennai**; DPIIT/Commerce
First Indian GI	Darjeeling Tea teaching
UP culture GIs	Banarasi brocade; Chikankari
Blue Pottery	**Jaipur** (≠ UP)

Topic 17 — UP Art, Culture & Demographics

Consolidated — 34 Must-Score Facts (UP Special)

1. **Sex Ratio Extremes (Census 2011):** Highest sex ratio is **Jaunpur (जौनपुर) (1024)**, followed by Azamgarh (1019) and Deoria (1017). Lowest sex ratio is **Gautam Buddha (बुद्ध) Nagar (851)**.
2. **Density Extremes:** Highest population (जनसंख्या) density is **Ghaziabad (3971 per sq. km)**; lowest is **Lalitpur (242 per sq. km)**. State average is **829**.
3. **Literacy Extremes:** Highest literacy is **Gautam Buddha Nagar (80.1%)**; lowest literacy (overall, male, and female) is **Shrawasti (46.7% overall; 34.8% female)**. Highest female literacy district is **Kanpur Nagar (75.1%)**.
4. **SC & ST Population:** Highest percentage of SC is in **Kaushambi (कौशांबी) (34.7%)**; highest absolute (निरपेक्ष) SC population is in **Sitapur**. Highest ST population (both absolute and percentage) is in **Sonbhadra (सोनभद्र) (20.7%)**; lowest/negligible ST population is in **Baghpat and Jalaun**.
5. Child sex ratio extremes: highest **Balrampur (950)**; lowest **Baghpat (841)**. Most populous district is **Prayagraj (प्रयागराज)**; least is **Mahoba**.
6. **Charkula (चरकुला) Folk (लोक) Dance:** Iconic (साकार) folk dance of the **Braj (ब्रज) region (Mathura (मथुरा))** wherein women balance a multi-tiered wooden pyramid (पिरामिड) holding **108 lit oil lamps** on their heads.
7. **Karma (कर्म) Folk Dance:** Performed in **Sonbhadra and Mirzapur (मिर्ज़ापुर)** by tribal (आदिवासी) communities (Kharwar, Kol, and Baiga) as an offering to Karma devta for agricultural prosperity.
8. **Rai (राई) Folk Dance:** Traditional peacock dance of **Bundelkhand** performed by women of the Beriya community on auspicious occasions like Janmashtami (जन्माष्टमी).
9. **Heroic Ballad 'Alha (आल्हा)':** Celebrated heroic folk song (सोंग) of **Bundelkhand** composed in *Banaffari* (बनफरी) dialect narrating the 52 battles of warrior brothers Alha and Udal.
10. **Monsoon Song 'Kajri (कजरी)':** Centred in **Mirzapur and Varanasi (वाराणसी)**; sung by women during the rainy season (*Shravan*) expressing longing and separation. **Birha** is Purvanchal (पूर्वांचल) Yadav narrative song, not Alha.
11. **Bateshwar (बटेश्वर) Fair (बटेश्वर मेला):** Held at **Bateshwar (Agra)** on the banks of Yamuna (यमुना); ancient cattle/camel and animal trade (पण्याध्यक्ष) fair.
12. **Nauchandi (नौचंदी) Fair (नौचंदी मेला):** Held at **Meerut** (मेरठ) on the second Sunday after Holi (होली); historic (ऐतिहासिक) symbol of Hindu-Muslim communal harmony (Chandi Devi temple and Bale Miyan dargah).
13. **Dewa Sharif (देवा शरीफ) Fair:** Held at **Barabanki** during Kartik month at the shrine of Sufi (सूफी) saint **Haji Waris Ali Shah** (हाजी वारिस अली शाह).
14. **Syed Salar Masood Ghazi (सैयद सालार मसूद गाजी) Fair:** Held at **Bahraich** at the dargah of Ghazi Miyan (गाजी मियाँ).
15. **Dadri (ददरी) Cattle Fair:** Celebrated at **Ballia** on Kartik Purnima (कार्तिक पूर्णिमा) in honour of sage Bhrigu; second largest cattle fair in India after Sonepur.
16. **Hathras (हाथरस) vs Kanpur (कानपुर) Nautanki (नौटंकी):** Hathras school is classical, poetic, and music-oriented; Kanpur school is theatrical, prose-dialogue, and performance-oriented.
17. **Kathak (कथक) Titans of Lucknow (लखनऊ):** Founded by Ishwari Prasad; carried forward by Kalka-Bindadin Maharaj, Achhan Maharaj, Shambhu Maharaj, Lachhu Maharaj, and **Pandit Birju Maharaj (बिरजू)**.
18. **Kirana (किराना) Gharana (घराना):** Founded by **Ustad Abdul Karim Khan** and **Abdul Wahid Khan** in Kirana (Shamli/Muzaffarnagar); celebrated by **Pandit Bhimsen Joshi** (Bharat Ratna (भारत रत्न) 2008) and Gangubai Hangal.
19. **Agra Gharana** (Rangeela) is linked with **Haji Sujan Khan** and later **Ustad Faiyaz Khan**. **Banaras** is the shehnai–tabla–thumri home of Bismillah Khan, Kishan Maharaj, and Girija Devi.
20. **Atrauli Gharana** of Aligarh (अलीगढ़) is linked with **Ustad Alladiya Khan** and vakra raga patterns.
21. Craft–city matches: **Banarasi** brocade (Varanasi), **Chikankari** and **Zardozi** (Lucknow), **Bhadohi** carpets, **Moradabad** brass, **Firozabad** glass, **Khurja** pottery, **Kannauj** (कन्नौज) attar, **Saharanpur** wood, **Nizamabad** black pottery.

22. Further GI / ODOP tags include **Gulabi Meenakari** and Banarasi paan (Varanasi), **Gorakhpur terracotta**, **Aligarh locks**, **Kalanamak rice** (Siddharthnagar), **Surkha guava** (Prayagraj), and **Mahoba Gaura Patthar**.
23. **IVRI** = **Bareilly (Izatnagar)**; **IIPR** = **Kanpur**; **IISR** = **Lucknow**; **IIVR** = **Varanasi** (वाराणसी). **NSI** (sugar technology) is **Kanpur**, not Lucknow.
24. **IGFRI Jhansi:** Indian Grassland and Fodder Research Institute is located at **Jhansi** (झांसी) (established 1962). **CIRG** (goats) is at **Makhdoom, Farah (Mathura)**.
25. Lucknow science cluster: **CDRI**, **CIMAP**, **NBRI**, **IITR**, **BSIP**, and **NBFGR**. Do not park IIPR or NSI inside Lucknow.
26. **BHU** (Varanasi) was founded in **1916** by **Madan Mohan Malaviya (मालवीय)**. Sampurnanand Sanskrit Vishwavidyalaya continues the **1791** Jonathan Duncan Sanskrit College line.
27. First Agricultural University **GBPUAT Pantnagar** (**1960**) was established in undivided UP before Uttarakhand (उत्तराखंड) (**2000**). Within current UP borders, **CSAUAT Kanpur** dates to **1975**.
28. **Raslila** and **Ramlila** are UP folk theatre of Braj and Ramnagar–Varanasi. Manipuri classical Ras Lila is a separate tradition.
29. **Mayur** dance is Braj peacock folk. **Chhath** (छठ) is eastern UP–Bihar sun worship, not a dance school.
30. Bateshwar is Agra cattle fair. Dadri is Ballia cattle fair. Dewa Sharif is Barabanki. Syed Salar is Bahraich. Keep the four pairs separate.
31. Highest urban share is **Ghaziabad**; highest rural share is **Shrawasti**. State urbanisation is about **22.3%** (Census 2011).
32. **CARI** (avian) sits with IVRI at Izatnagar. **CIRC** (cattle) is at Meerut. **CPPRI** (paper) is at Saharanpur.
33. **HRI** (Harish-Chandra Research Institute) is at Jhunsi, Prayagraj. **V. V. Giri National Labour Institute** is at Noida.
34. UP art–culture stems usually decide on **district + craft/fair/gharana**. Match the place first, then the tradition name.

Uttarakhand — Topic 1 — Folk Culture of UK

Consolidated — 28 Must-Score Facts

1. **Aipan** (ऐपण) is Kumaon (कुमाऊँ) ritual floor and wall art painted with **Geru** (गेरू) (red ochre ground) and **Biswar** (बिसवार) (white rice paste).
2. Aipan received a **GI tag** in **September 2021**. Motifs are applied with the ring finger (*Anamika*) and middle finger of the right hand.
3. **Dhuli Arghya Chauki** is drawn to welcome the bridegroom. **Lakshmi Padchinha** are Diwali (दिवाली) white footprints leading into the home.
4. **Jyoti Patta / Bar-Boond** is genealogical wall painting for namkaran, yajnopavit, and weddings. **Asan Chauki** is drawn on ritual wooden seats.
5. In **Jagar** (जागर), the **Jagaria** (जगरिया) is the singer-chanter of deity genealogies. The **Dangariya** (डंगरिया) is the spirit medium in trance.
6. The *Syana* is the elder interrogator who questions the Dangariya on behalf of the afflicted family.
7. Deities invoked in Jagar include **Golu / Gwal Devta** (justice; Chitai and Ghorakhal), **Narsingh**, **Bhairav**, **Gangnath**, **Haru–Chhurmal**, and mountain fairies (*Aanchhari*).
8. **Ramman** (रम्माण) of **Saloor-Dungra** (सलूर-डुंगरा) in **Chamoli** (चमोली) entered UNESCO ICH on **2 October 2009**.
9. Ramman is dedicated to **Bhumiyal Devta** (भूमियाल देवता). It uses about **18** wooden masks (*Mukhota*) without spoken dialogue.
10. Ramman mask classes are **Dyot Pattar** (sacred deities such as Narsingh) and **Khyari Pattar** (comic / historical figures).
11. Ramman dance acts include **Mal-Nrit** (Garhwali–Gorkha combat), **Kurukhyo**, and **Baniya–Baniyan**. Rhythm uses **Dhol–Damau** and copper **Bhankoras**.
12. **Hiljatra** (हिलजात्रा) of the **Sor Valley, Pithoragarh** (पिथौरागढ़) is a monsoon paddy-planting festival whose climax figure is **Lakhia Bhoot** (लाखिया भूत).
13. Hiljatra tradition is linked with the Kathmandu Indra (इन्द्र) Jatra (यात्रा) line. Do not confuse it with Nanda Raj Jat.
14. **Pawada / Bhada** (पावाड़ा) are heroic martial ballads of Madho Singh, Kafu Chauhan, Jeetu Bagdwal, and related warriors.
15. **Khuded** (खुदेड) songs are melancholy bride songs longing for the maternal home (*Mait*).
16. **Bair** songs are competitive intellectual duels between Kumaon bards. **Neoli** songs are romantic Kumaon lyrics of separation.
17. **Jhumailo** (झुमैलो) is a Garhwal spring song welcoming *Buransh* (बुरांश) blossom. **Hurkiya Baul** (हुड़किया बौल) is a Kumaon paddy-transplant song with the *Hurka* drum.
18. **Mangal Geet** are auspicious ceremonial songs sung by *Mangal-mukhi* women at weddings and births.
19. Aipan is **not** dry-powder rangoli. Ramman is **not** dialogue Ramlila of the plains.
20. Jagaria is **not** the possessed medium. Dangariya is **not** the lead chanter.
21. Ramman village is **Saloor-Dungra**, not every Chamoli fairground. Hiljatra home is **Pithoragarh**, not Champawat Bagwal.
22. Golu Devta is the justice deity of Chitai / Ghorakhal, distinct from Bhumiyal Devta of Ramman.
23. Folk song spine: Pawada = heroics; Khuded = longing; Bair = debate; Neoli = romance; Hurkiya Baul = agriculture.
24. Aipan special Chauki and Padchinha motifs decide wedding and Diwali stems; Geru + Biswar decide material stems.
25. UNESCO year for Ramman is **2009**. GI year for Aipan is **2021**. Do not swap the two years.
26. Lakhia Bhoot is a horned attendant figure of Hiljatra fertility blessing, not a Ramman mask class.
27. Jagar instruments commonly include **Dhol–Damau** or **Dor–Thali**. Do not reduce Jagar to dance alone.

28. UK folk culture here is ritual and oral community practice. It is not SNA classical dance and not Mughal miniature painting.

📋 Must-Score Facts (High-Yield UKPCS)

1. **Aipan Raw (रॉ) Materials & GI Tag:** - Ground wash: **Geru** (natural red clay / ochre). - Painted motifs: **Biswar** (wet rice soaked overnight and ground into a fine white paste). - Applied using the ring finger (*Anamika*) and middle finger of the right hand. - Accorded official **Geographical Indication (GI) Tag in September 2021**.
2. **Jagar Terminology Trap:** - **Jagaria:** The balladeer / priest who recites the genealogies of local deities while beating the *Dhol-Damau* or *Dor-Thali*. - **Dangariya:** The human vehicle/medium whose body is possessed by the deity (*Devta aana*) and who dances in a trance.
3. **Ramman Festival (UNESCO 2009):** - Village: **Saloor-Dungra** (Painkhanda / Joshimath block, Chamoli). - Declared **UNESCO Intangible Cultural Heritage of Humanity on 2 October 2009**. - Timing: Annual festival in late April (Baisakhi (बैसाखी) season); dedicated to **Bhumiyal Devta**. - Performance: Enactment of Ramayana (रामायण) episodes without spoken dialogue, using 18 distinctive carved wooden masks (*Mukhota*).
4. **Hiljatra & Lakhia Bhoot (Pithoragarh):** - Practiced exclusively in the **Sor Valley (Pithoragarh)** during the rainy season paddy planting (*Ropai*). - Mythological tradition received from Nepal (Kathmandu Indra (इन्द्र) Jatra (यात्रा)). - The climax of the performance is the entrance of **Lakhia Bhoot** (a ferocious attendant of Lord Shiva wearing a horned mask and black hair) who blesses the villagers for fertile crops and cattle protection.

Uttarakhand — Topic 2 — Dances, Music & Fairs

Consolidated — 30 Must-Score Facts

1. State animal of Uttarakhand is the **Alpine Musk Deer** (*Moschus chrysogaster* / Kasturi Mriga).
2. State bird is the **Himalayan Monal** (*Lophophorus impejanus* / Danfe). State tree is **Buransh** (बुरांश) (*Rhododendron arboreum*).
3. State flower is **Brahma Kamal** (ब्रह्मकमल) (*Saussurea obvallata* / *Kaul Padma*). State butterfly is the **Common Peacock** (*Papilio bianor*, **2016**).
4. State musical instruments are **Dhol and Damau**, notified in **2015**. State song (सोंग) (**2016**) is *"Uttarakhand Devbhumi Matribhumi"* (lyrics Hemant Bisht; music Narendra Singh Negi).
5. **Nanda Devi (नंदा देवी) Raj Jat** (नंदा देवी राज जात) runs every **12 years** for about **280 km** from **Nauti** to **Homkund** (त्रिशूल).
6. A four-horned ram (*Chasingya Khadu*) leads the Raj Jat. Golden canopies called **Chhatoli** are carried by Kansuwa descendants. Women traditionally stop at **Wan**.
7. **Devidhura (देवीधुरा) Bagwal (बग्वाल)** at **Champawat** (चंपावत) (Barahi temple) is the historic stone-pelting fair on Raksha Bandhan among four *Khams*.
8. **Jauljibi (जौलजीबी) Mela** at **Pithoragarh** (पिथौरागढ़) sits at the Gori–Kali (काली) confluence; started **1914** by Gajendra Bahadur Pal.
9. **Uttarayani Mela** at **Bageshwar** (बागेश्वर) (Saryu–Gomti) on Makar Sankranti (मकर संक्रांति) is the historic Coolie-Begar immersion venue of **1921**.
10. **Purnagiri Mela** (Champawat / Tanakpur) falls in Chaitra Navratri (नवरात्रि). **Chaiti (चैती) Mela** at Kashipur (Udham Singh Nagar (ऊधम सिंह नगर)) is linked with the Buksa tribe.
11. **Bissu Mela** of Jaunsar–Bawar (Dehradun (देहरादून)) on Baisakhi (बैसाखी) features the martial **Thoda** archery dance.
12. **Syaldey–Bikhauti** (Almora (अल्मोड़ा) / Dwarahat) and **Somnath (सोमनाथ) Mela** (Masi, Almora) are Baisakhi-season Kumaon fairs.
13. **Chholiya (छोलिया)** is the Kumaon (कुमाऊँ) martial sword dance of Rajput (राजपूत) weddings with shield and sword.
14. **Langvir Nritya** (लांगवीर नृत्य) is the Garhwal (गढ़वाल) acrobatic pole dance. **Pandav Nritya** (पांडव नृत्य) is Garhwal Mahabharata ritual dance-drama.
15. **Chaunfla** is a Garhwal romantic clap-and-footwork dance without instruments. **Thandya** is a maternal-courtyard dance of newly married daughters.
16. **Jhora (झोड़ा)** and **Chanchari** are Kumaon circular community dances. **Chhapeli** is a romantic duet with handkerchief or mirror.
17. **Hurkiya Baul** (हुड़किया बौल) is Kumaon agrarian paddy song with the *Hurka* drum. **Sarau** is a Garhwal martial sword dance.
18. Instrument map: **Dhol–Damau** (state pair), **Hurka** (hourglass), **Bhankora** (straight copper trumpet), **Ransingha** (curved brass horn), **Moshakbeen** (bagpipe), **Thali–Dor** (Jagar idiophones).
19. **Radha Bahin Bhatt** received **Padma Shri 2025** for **Social Work** (Lakshmi Ashram, Kausani). **Madhuri Barthwal** received Padma Shri **2022** for folk music.
20. Pandav Nritya of Garhwal is **not** Pandavani of Chhattisgarh. Chholiya is **not** Chhapeli.
21. Devidhura is Champawat stone Bagwal. Jauljibi is Pithoragarh trade mela. Do not swap districts.
22. Nanda Raj Jat starts at **Nauti** and ends at **Homkund**, not Roopkund as the terminal shrine.
23. State flower is Brahma Kamal. State tree is Buransh. Do not reverse the two.
24. Dhol–Damau is the state instrument pair of **2015**, not Hurka alone.
25. Haridwar (हरिद्वार) Kumbh (कुंभ) and Ardh Kumbh sit on the state festival map beside hill melas, on a **12** and **6** year cycle.

26. **Gend Mela** of Pauri (पौड़ी) and **Vaikunth Chaturdashi** of Srinagar Garhwal are regional Garhwal calendar fairs.
27. Monal is also Nepal's national bird (*Danfe*). That does not move the Uttarakhand state-bird tag.
28. Musk deer habitat memory often cites Kedarnath (केदारनाथ) and Askot sanctuaries. Brahma Kamal is offered at Kedarnath.
29. Folk dances split by zone: Garhwal (Pandav, Langvir, Chaunfla, Thandya, Sarau) versus Kumaon (Chholiya, Jhora, Chanchari, Hurkiya Baul, Chhapeli).
30. These state symbols and fairs are UKPCS Unit 1 / GK heads. They are not SNA classical dance forms.

📋 Must-Score Facts (High-Yield UKPCS)

1. **State Symbols Official Ratta:** - *State Flower:* **Brahma Kamal** (*Saussurea obvallata*), blooms July–September between 3,600 and 4,800 m. Offered at Kedarnath (केदारनाथ). - *State Bird:* **Himalayan Monal** (*Lophophorus impejanus*), state bird of Uttarakhand and national bird of Nepal (*Danfe*). - *State Animal:* **Alpine Musk Deer** (*Moschus chrysogaster*), found in Kedarnath Wildlife Sanctuary (established 1972) and Askot Wildlife Sanctuary (Pithoragarh, 1986). - *State Musical Instrument:* **Dhol** (notified in 2015 under recommendation of Bhandari Committee).
2. **Nanda Devi Raj Jat Yatra ("Himalayan Mahakumbh"):** - Frequency: Every **12 years**. - Route: Starts from **Nauti village** (Chamoli (चमोली)) and terminates at **Homkund** (at base of Mount Trishul (त्रिशूल)). - Total Distance: **280 km** on foot across 19–20 days through 19 halts. - Sacred Leader: A born **four-horned ram (*Chasingya Khadu*)** leads the yatra bearing the offering (*Pitolya*); leaves alone towards higher glaciers at Homkund. - Sacred Umbrellas: Golden canopies called **Chhatoli** carried by Kansuwa royal descendants. - Women are traditionally not allowed beyond **Wan village** (the last inhabited village).
3. **Devidhura Bagwal Mela (Champawat):** Held on Raksha Bandhan at the **Maa Barahi Devi Temple**. Traditionally, 4 clans (*Khams* (ख़म्स): Chamyal, Gaharwal, Walik, Lamgariya) pelted stones at each other using bamboo shields (*Chhatoli*) until blood equivalent to one human sacrifice was shed. Now played with flowers, walnuts, and pears.
4. **Padma Shri 2025 Traps (UKPCS 2025 Q53):** Smt. Radha Bahin Bhatt received the Padma Shri in 2025 for **Social Work** (associated with Sarvodaya and Lakshmi Ashram, Kausani). Do not confuse with Dr. Madhuri Barthwal who received Padma Shri in 2022 for **Art / Folk Music**.

Uttarakhand — Topic 3 — Heritage & Cultural Institutes

Consolidated — 32 Must-Score Facts

1. **Nanda Devi (नंदा देवी) National Park** (**1988**) and **Valley of Flowers (फूलों की घाटी) National Park** (extension **2005**) form **one** UNESCO World Natural Heritage property in Chamoli (चमोली).
2. **Ramman (रम्माण) (2009)** is UNESCO ICH of **Saloor-Dungra (सलूर-डुंगरा) (Chamoli)** dedicated to **Bhumiyal Devta** (भूमियाल देवता).
3. Garhwal (गढ़वाल) painting begins in **May 1658** when **Shyamdas** and **Hardas** arrived with Sulaiman Shikoh at the court of **Raja (राजा) Prithvipati Shah** and received the post of ***Tasbirdar*** *(तस्बीरदार)*.
4. **Mola Ram** (मोला राम) (**1743–1833**) is the supreme Garhwal painter-poet. **Barrister Mukandi Lal** popularised the school in *Garhwal Painting* (**1969**).
5. After Gorkha and British partition, **Chetu** and **Manku** worked under Raja **Sudarshan Shah** at **Tehri** (टिहरी).
6. **IIT Roorkee** began in **1847** as Thomason College of Civil Engineering and became the **7th IIT** in **2001**.
7. **GBPUAT Pantnagar** (Udham Singh Nagar (ऊधम सिंह नगर)), inaugurated **17 November 1960** by Nehru (जवाहरलाल नेहरू), is India's first agricultural university and the "Cradle of the Green Revolution (हरित क्रांति)".
8. **Forest Research Institute (FRI)** (वन अनुसंधान संस्थान) at **Dehradun** (देहरादून) was established **1906**; the Greco-Roman main building was inaugurated in **1929** by Lord Irwin (इरविन).
9. **Survey of India** HQ is at **Dehradun**. The department was founded in **1767**; HQ shifted permanently to Dehradun in **1942**.
10. **Indian Military Academy (IMA)** at Dehradun was inaugurated **1 October 1932** by Field Marshal Sir Philip Chetwode; motto *Veerta Aur Vivek* (वीरता और विवेक).
11. **LBSNAA** at **Mussoorie** (मसूरी) began in **1959** at Charleville Hotel as the apex IAS / civil services academy.
12. **ARIES** at Manora Peak (**Nainital (नैनीताल)**) began in **1954** at Varanasi (वाराणसी) and shifted in **1955**; it houses the **3.6 m Devasthal Optical Telescope**.
13. **IVRI Mukteshwar** (**Nainital**) was established **1893** by **Dr. Alfred Lingard** as the Imperial Bacteriological Laboratory and developed the Rinderpest vaccine.
14. **DCFR** (Coldwater Fisheries) sits at **Bhimtal (Nainital)** from **1987**. It is **not** at Haldwani.
15. **VPKAS** at **Almora** (अल्मोड़ा) was founded in **1924** in Kolkata by **Prof. Boshi Sen** and transferred to Almora in **1936**.
16. **G.B. Pant National Institute of Himalayan Environment (NIHE)** is at **Kosi-Katarmal (Almora)** from **1988**.
17. **Wadia Institute of Himalayan Geology (WIHG)** was founded **1968** (Delhi) by **Prof. D.N. Wadia** and shifted to Dehradun in **1976**.
18. **Herbal Research and Development Institute (HRDI)** is at **Mandal, Gopeshwar (Chamoli)** from **1989**.
19. **Wildlife Institute of India (WII)** is at Chandrabani, Dehradun (**1982**, MoEFCC). **IIRS** (ISRO) is at Dehradun (**1966**).
20. **IGNFA** (IFS staff college) is at Dehradun (**1987**). **ONGC** national HQ is at Tel Bhavan, Dehradun (**1956**).
21. **CBRI** (CSIR building research) and **NIH** (hydrology, Jal Shakti) sit at **Roorkee** (**1947** and **1978**).
22. **Gurukul Kangri** at Haridwar (हरिद्वार) was founded **1902** by **Swami Shraddhanand**. **Uttarakhand Sanskrit University** at Haridwar dates to **2005**.
23. **Nehru Institute of Mountaineering (NIM)** at **Uttarkashi (उत्तरकाशी)** began in **1965**. **HAPPRC** alpine plant centre is at Srinagar Garhwal (**1979**).
24. **Uday Shankar Academy of Dance and Drama** at Almora dates to **2003**, recalling Uday Shankar's 1938–44 India Cultural Centre.
25. **Pushpesh Pant** is the culinary / IR scholar of UKPCS fame; *Himalaya Ke Barf* (हिमालय के बर्फ) is **not** his book.
26. **Kaziranga** and the Mountain Railways are World Heritage sites **outside** Uttarakhand. VoF + Nanda Devi are the UK pair.

27. IVRI historical vaccine work is **Mukteshwar (UK)**; the later main plains campus is **Izatnagar, Bareilly (UP)**.
28. Tasbirdar is a Garhwal court painter post. It is not a Mughal mansab rank.
29. FRI foundation year is **1906**; the grand building inauguration year is **1929**. Do not collapse the two dates.
30. IIT Roorkee foundation is **1847**; IIT status year is **2001**. Do not treat them as one stamp.
31. ASI Dehradun Circle and state heritage bodies protect monuments; UNESCO WHS status for VoF–Nanda Devi is a separate international inscription.
32. Garhwal painting is a **Pahari** hill school. It is not a Rajasthan plains Rajput atelier and not Kangra itself.

Uttarakhand — Topic 4 — Personalities, Literature & Press

Consolidated — 28 Must-Score Facts

1. ***The Hills*** (Mussoorie (मसूरी), **1842**), published by **John Mckinnon**, is the first newspaper of Uttarakhand / the north Indian hill belt.
2. ***Samay Vinod (समय विनोद)*** **(Nainital (नैनीताल),** 1868**), edited by** Jay Datt Joshi**, is the first Hindi/Urdu vernacular fortnightly of the region.
3. ***Almora (अल्मोड़ा) Akhbar (अल्मोड़ा अखबार)*** **(**1871**) began under the Debating Club with editor** Buddhi Ballabh Pant**;** Badridatt Pandey **edited from** 1913**; banned** 1918**.
4. Weekly ***Shakti (शक्ति)*** **launched on** 15 October 1918 (Vijayadashami (विजयादशमी)) **by** Badridatt Pandey** after the Almora Akhbar ban.
5. ***Garhwali*** (**1905**, Dehradun (देहरादून)) was edited by **Girija Datt Naithani** and **Tara (तारा) Datt Gairola**. ***Garhwal Samachar*** (**1902**, Dugadda) preceded it under Naithani.
6. ***Karmabhoomi (कर्मभूमि)*** **(**1939**, Lansdowne (लैंसडाउन)) was edited by** Bhairav Datt Dhulia **and** Bhakt Darshan**.
7. ***Yugvani (युगवाणी)*** **(**1947**, Dehradun) was edited by** Bhagwati Prasad Panthari **and** Gopeshwar Kothiyal**.
8. ***Samta (समता)*** **(Almora,** 1934**) by** Munshi Hari Prasad Tamta** is the first Dalit (दलित) / Shilpkar newspaper of Uttarakhand.
9. ***Tarun Bharat*** (**1922**, Lansdowne) was linked with **Barrister Mukandi Lal** (लैंसडाउन). ***Swadhin Praja*** (**1930**, Almora) was edited by **Victor Mohan Joshi**.
10. **Dr. Pitambar Datt Barthwal** earned the first Hindi D.Litt (**1931**) for *The Nirguna (निर्गुण) School of Hindi Poetry*.
11. **Sumitranandan Pant** (Kausani, Almora) won the first Hindi **Jnanpith (ज्ञानपीठ) (1968)** for ***Chidambara*** *(चिदंबरा)*.
12. **"Kumaon (कुमाऊँ) Kesari (कुमाऊँ केसरी)"** is **Badridatt Pandey** (Coolie-Begar **1921**; *Kumaon Ka Itihas* (कुमाऊँ का इतिहास)).
13. **"Garh Kesari (गढ़ केसरी)"** is **Anusuya Prasad Bahuguna**. **"Uttarakhand Gandhi (उत्तराखंड के गांधी)"** is **Indramani Badoni** (Tehri (टिहरी) statehood fast).
14. **"Charan (चारण)" / encyclopedia historian** is **Dr. Shiv Prasad Dabral** (*Uttarakhand Ka Itihas* (उत्तराखंड का इतिहास), Dugadda).
15. **"Himalaya (हिमालय) Putra (हिमालय पुत्र)"** is **Pandit Govind Ballabh Pant** (Bharat Ratna (भारत रत्न) **1957**).
16. **"The Pundit"** explorer-cartographer is **Pandit Nain Singh Rawat** (RGS Royal Patron's Medal **1876**).
17. **"Chipko (चिपको) Mata (चिपको माता)"** is **Gaura Devi** of the Reni forest action (**1974**).
18. **Major Somnath (सोमनाथ) Sharma** (4 Kumaon) is India's first **Param Vir Chakra** (Battle of Badgam, **1947**).
19. **Bachendri Pal** (Nakuri, Uttarkashi (उत्तरकाशी)) was the first Indian woman on Everest (**23 May 1984**).
20. **Prof. Shekhar Pathak** founded the journal *PAHAR* and wrote *The Chipko Movement*. **Dr. D. D. Sharma** documented Himalayan languages (Padma Shri).
21. Press chronology spine: Hills **1842** → Samay Vinod **1868** → Almora Akhbar **1871** → Garhwali **1905** → Shakti **1918** → Samta **1934** → Karmabhoomi **1939** → Yugvani **1947**.
22. Badridatt Pandey links Almora Akhbar, Shakti, Coolie-Begar, and *Kumaon Ka Itihas*. Do not split those tags across unrelated editors.
23. First newspaper is English *The Hills*. First vernacular is *Samay Vinod*. First Dalit paper is *Samta*.
24. Pant's Jnanpith is **1968** for *Chidambara*. Barthwal's D.Litt is **1931**. Do not swap literary firsts.
25. Indramani Badoni is Uttarakhand Gandhi of the statehood struggle. Gaura Devi is Chipko Mata of Reni. Keep sobriquets distinct.
26. Mukandi Lal appears in press (*Tarun Bharat*) and in Garhwal painting rediscovery (*Garhwal Painting*, **1969**).
27. Sports–gallantry spine for UK: Somnath Sharma (first PVC) and Bachendri Pal (first Indian woman on Everest).

28. These press, sobriquet, and personality facts are UKPCS Unit 1 / GK heads. They are not national akademi award lists.